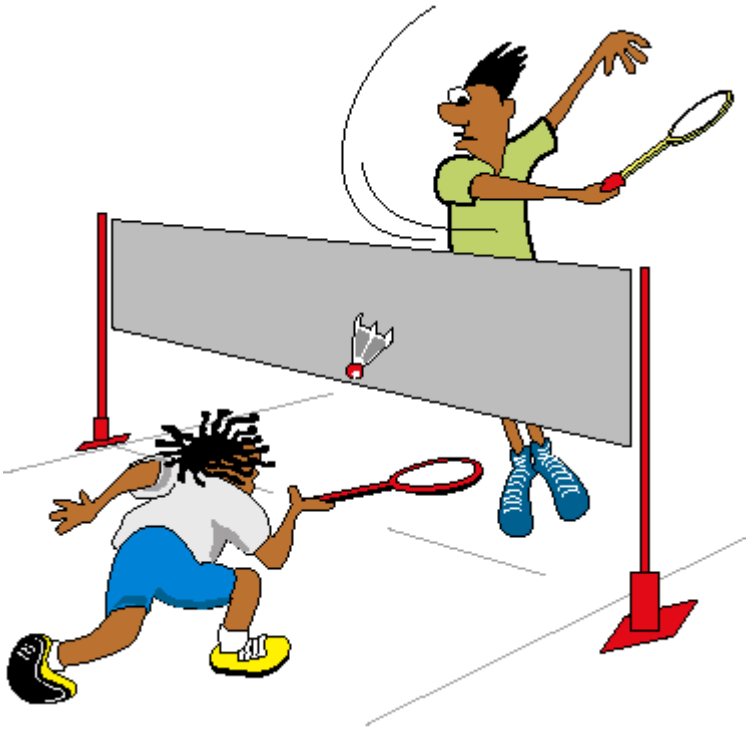
Badminton Association of Sri Lanka

SLBA COACH EDUCATION LEVEL - 1



Badminton Coach Education Manual

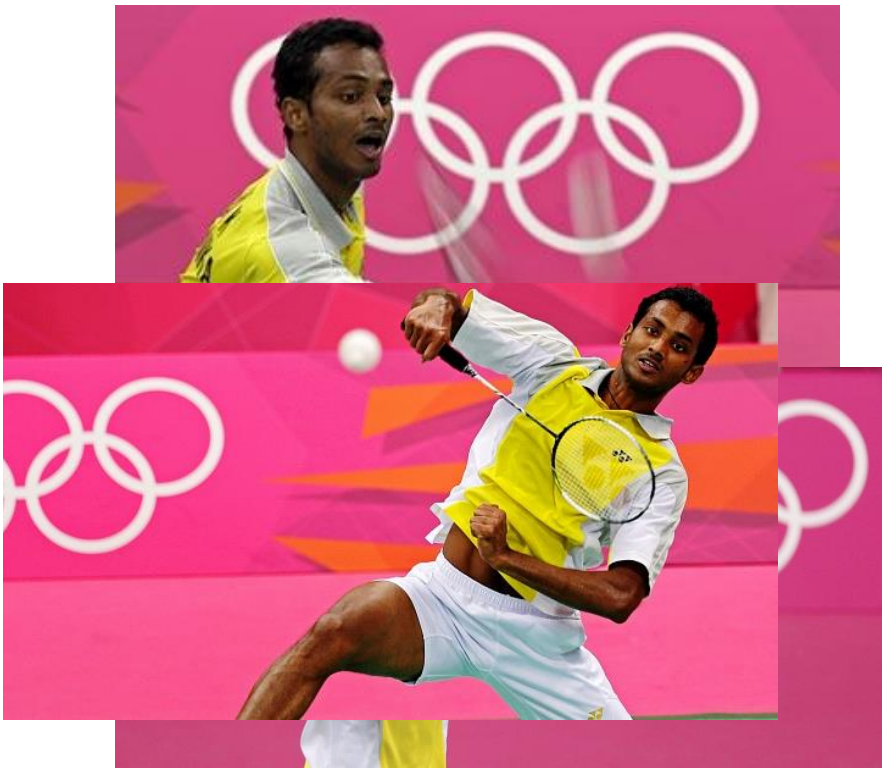
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CONTENTS

		Page No.
1.	THE ORIGINS OF BADMINTON	02
2.	MODULE –1 COACHING PRINICIPLES	03
3.	MODULE -2 SHUTTLE FEEDING	07
4.	MODULE – 3 COACHING CHILDREN	10
5.	MODULE – 4 PERFORMANCE FACTORS 1 TECHNICAL (MOVEMENT SKILLS)	12
6.	MODULE – 5 PERFORMANCE FACTORS 1 TECHNICAL (HITTING SKILLS)	18
7.	MODULE – 6 PERFORMANCE FACTORS 2 TACTICS	53
8.	MODULE - 7 SPORTS NUTRITION	79
9.	MODULE – 8 SPORTS SAFETY	82



THE ORIGINS OF BADMINTON

Although the exact origins of badminton are unclear, games based on a shuttlecock and a battledore were played in China, Japan, India, Siam and Greece over 2000 years ago.

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Between 1856 and 1859 a game known as 'battledore and shuttlecock' started to evolve into the modern game of badminton at "Badminton House", the Duke of Beaufort's country estate in England.

Similar games were played in Poona India around this time and a badminton code of conduct was drawn up in 1877.

The aim of battledore and shuttlecock played at "Badminton House" was to keep the shuttlecock in the air for as long as possible by hitting the shuttle between two or more people. The reverse is true today. The aim now is to finish a rally as quickly as possible by scoring winning points against your opponent.

In 1893, the Badminton Association of England was formed to administer the game internationally from England.

REGULATING BADMINTON WORLDWIDE

The International Badminton Federation (IBF) was established in 1934 and consisted of nine founding members – badminton associations from Canada, Denmark, England, France, Ireland, Netherlands, New Zealand, Scotland and Wales.

In 2006 the IBF changed its name to the Badminton World Federation (BWF).

The BWF is the world governing body for the sport of badminton, recognized by the International Olympic Committee (IOC).

BWF's members are, with a few exceptions, the national governing bodies for badminton. These are organized into five confederations under the IOC system, with each Continental Confederation representing one of the five Olympic rings – Africa, Asia, Europe, Oceania and Pan America.

CONTINENTAL CONFEDERATIONS

- **Badminton Africa www.badmintonafrica.org**
- **Badminton Asia / (SLBA) www.badmintonasia.org**
- **Badminton Europe www.badmintoneurope.com**
- **Badminton Pan Am www.badmintonpanam.org**
- **Badminton Oceania www.oceaniabadminton.org**

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MODULE 1
COACHING PRINCIPLES

INTRODUCTION

The sport of badminton has the potential to provide a very positive effect on participants. Coaches play a very big role in creating an environment where these positive effects can be developed. However to do this, coaches need to have a clear understanding of their own roles and responsibilities.

Effective coaches are aware of their own coaching philosophy and style, but can also adapt this if required to meet the needs of the participants.

POSITIVE BENEFITS OF BADMINTON PARTICIPATION

Badminton offers the opportunity for lifelong participation in a sport. It offers a large number of benefits which can be listed under the headings of physical, social, emotional and intellectual.

BENEFITS OF BADMINTON			
PHYSICAL	SOCIAL	EMOTIONAL	INTELLECTUAL
• health and fitness benefits	• friendship • shared experiences • working in a group	• fun • sense of achievement • confidence • sporting behavior	• problem solving • skill development

SUPPORTING POSITIVE EXPERIENCES

Unfortunately, as with any sport, there is the possibility for badminton to have a negative effect upon people, such as injury, obsessive behavior, loss of confidence and poor sporting behavior.

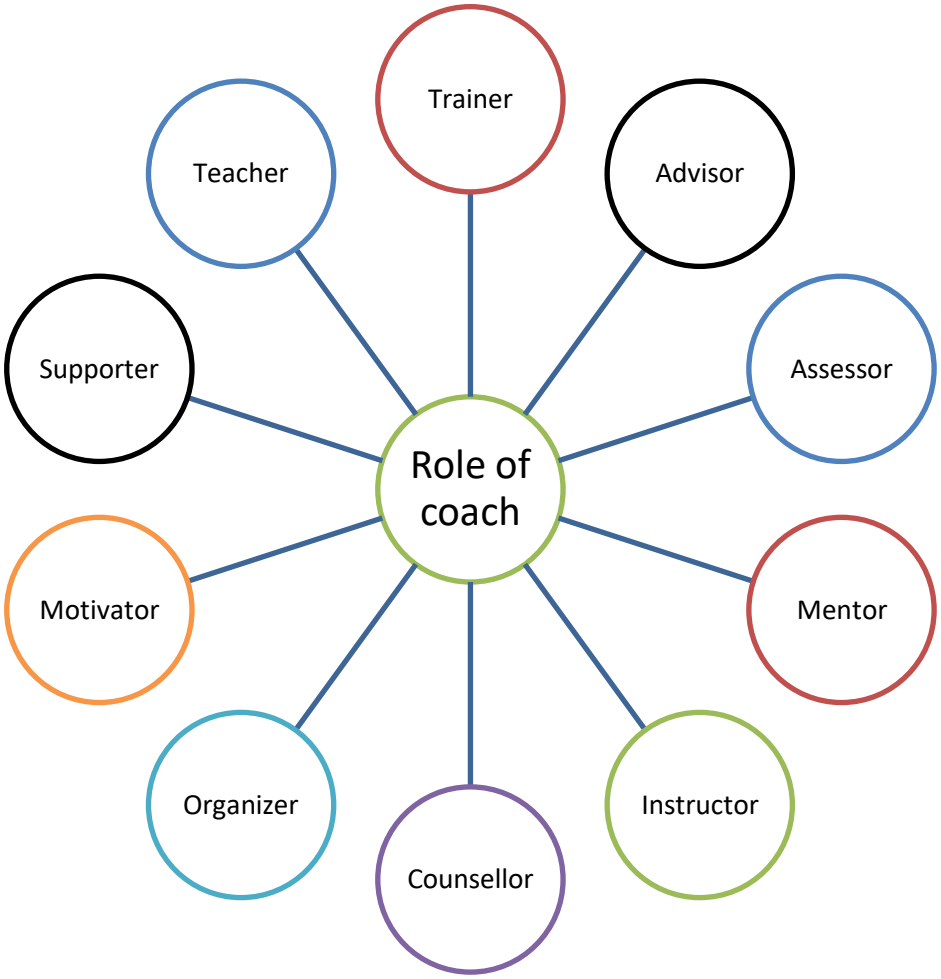
Whilst many of these factors are within the control of the player, the coach can have a significant influence on whether the badminton experience is positive or negative.

Warming up and cooling down, putting personal development before winning, encouraging sporting behavior, creating an environment where everyone works together are all ways in which the coach can have a positive effect.

ROLE OF THE COACH

An effective coach has to undertake a number of roles, many of which are interlinked. The diagram below includes typical roles that a coach might have to fulfill.

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RESPONSIBILITIES OF COACHES

Coaches are in a very powerful position and carry with them a significant responsibility. These responsibilities are wide-ranging and can be grouped under the following:

- **RESPECTING PARTICIPANTS**
- **COACHING RESPONSIBLY**
- **BUILDING AND MAINTAINING RELATIONSHIPS**
- **RESPECTING THE SPORT**

RESPECT FORPARTICIPANTS

PRINCIPLE - Coaches should recognize that every person has value and is worthy of respect.

- **Treat people equally, whatever their gender, race, playing potential, color, sexual orientation, political beliefs, economic status, age, disability etc.**
- **Promote the rights of participants, including aspects such as confidentiality, sharing of decision making and fairness of procedures.**
- **Work with others in a way that allows participants to maintain their dignity.**
- **Build mutual support among fellow coaches, officials, players, teachers and family members.**

COACHING RESPONSIBLY

PRINCIPLE - Coaches should engage in activities that will maximize the benefits and minimize the risks to society in general and players in particular.

- **Act in the best interests of athlete's development as a whole person.**

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- **Recognize the power inherent in their coaching role.**
- **Be aware of their own personal values and how this affects their coaching practice.**
- **Acknowledge the limitations of their discipline.**
- **Accept the responsibility to work with other coaches and professionals in sport.**
- **Commit to continuous professional development in order to keep their coaching practice up to date.**
- **Develop the coaching profession by exchange of knowledge and experiences with others within the sport.**

BUILDING AND MAINTAINING RELATIONSHIPS

PRINCIPLE - Coaches are expected to build and maintain effective relationships.

- **Reflect on their own coaching philosophy and how this influences their interactions with others in sport.**
- **Communicate honestly and openly with players, participants, parents, teachers, other coaches.**
- **Fulfill commitments that are made.**
- **Avoid exploiting relationships in a way that restricts your ability to act in the best interest of others.**
- **Declare conflicts of interest - seek to manage them in a way that respects the best interests of those involved.**
- **Encourage players to build and maintain effective relationships with others.**

RESPECTING THE SPORT

PRINCIPLE - Coaches should recognize, act on and promote the value of badminton for players and for society in general.

- **Maintain the highest standards of personal presentation and conduct.**
- **Discourage the use of drugs, recreational or performance enhancing.**
- **Act on and promote positive values related to coaching in general and badminton specifically, such as fair play, self-discipline, integrity, personal development, challenging yourself.**
- **Respect both the letter and spirit of the laws that govern badminton and promote the same respectful approach amongst player, parents, teachers and other coaches.**
- **Respect officials and other coaches.**

IMPORTANCE OF A COACHING PHILOSOPHY

A coaching philosophy can be defined as:

> **"The set of personal principles and beliefs that form the foundations of your coaching delivery"**

For example, honesty might be a personal principle that underpins your coaching delivery.

All coaches have a coaching philosophy – personal principles and beliefs that have been formed as a result of your personality, upbringing, education and life experiences.

For many coaches this coaching philosophy exists subconsciously. It is there, but the coach has little appreciation of how it influences their delivery – in effect the coach has little "self-awareness". The issues surrounding this are:

- **A coach lacks self-awareness, and therefore they are probably unaware of their coaching strengths and weaknesses.**
- **This means they are less likely to make maximum use of those coaching strengths, nor seek to address their coaching weaknesses.**
- **A coach will lack the ability to make conscious decisions to adapt their style. This is a weakness, since not all players, parents; coaches are involved in badminton for the same reasons. The coach has to be able to adapt to meet the needs of others involved in the sport, especially the players!**

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Taking time to decide on your coaching philosophy can help by:

- **raising your own self-awareness;**
- **appreciating your strengths and developing your weaknesses;**
- **adapting your delivery to the differing needs of the players.**

All of these can contribute to making you a better coach.

ESTABLISHING YOUR COACHING PHILOSOPHY

Completing the following questions and tasks can help you to clearly establish your own coaching philosophy.

- **Describe the personal principles and beliefs by which you live your life.**
- **How would you describe your coaching style and how it is influenced by your personal principles and beliefs?**
- **What do others say about your personal principles/coaching style?**
- **How do you communicate your coaching philosophy to others within the sport (e.g. players, parents, etc.)**
- **What personal strengths do you have that help your coaching?**
- **What are the weaknesses of your coaching and how are you seeking to improve them?**
- **What are the needs of the people you coach – i.e. what do they want to get out of badminton?**
- **How do you adapt your personal principles and coaching style to meet the needs of others?**

COACHING STYLES

There are many different coaching styles that can be used, but they all tend to fall between the two extremes of autocratic and democratic coaching styles.

Autocratic coaching involves the coach defining what needs to be done and how to do it. The coach does a lot of telling in this style and the player has no involvement in decision-making. The advantages of this approach for the coach are that it is easier to control and often quicker. The disadvantages for the player are that this approach does not develop their own problem-solving and decision-making skills.

Democratic coaching is where the coach allows the player to take more ownership of what they need to develop and how to go about doing it. The advantage of this approach is that it develops the self-reliance of players, improving their problem-solving and decision-making. The disadvantage is that this can be slower and harder for the coach to manage, involving a more flexible approach and greater use of questioning skills.

Different styles may need to be used depending on the size of group, the experience of players and the situation.

SUMMARY

Badminton can offer a wide range of positive benefits to players of all ages. Badminton coaches play an important role in helping to establish and maintain a positive badminton environment.

To support the creation of this positive environment, coaches should adhere to the SLBA Coaches Code of Conduct, the content of which is consistent with the roles and responsibilities section of this document.

In order to improve, coaches should:

- **be aware of different coaching styles;**
- **develop their own self-awareness by considering their own personal philosophy;**
- **adapt their coaching style to the needs of the different participants within badminton.**

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MODULE 2
STUTTLE FEEDING

a) **Feeding Skills**

Feeding can be defined as:

> **"The ability to deliver a shuttle in a way that gives the player realistic practice opportunities"**

Feeding can involve:

- **Hand feeding**
- **Racket feeding – multifeed**
- **Racket feeding – rallying**

Whatever the type of feeding used, consider the following.

SAFETY

To avoid injury, especially eye injuries, make sure you feed from a safe position. This sometimes means you have to compromise a little on where you feed from.

FLIGHT PATH
Make the flight path of the feed as similar to the game as possible. For example, use an overhead throw from the rearcourt to forecourt in order to mimic the flight path of a dropshot.

PACE

It is impossible to throw a shuttle with the same pace as a shuttle struck with a racket. So where pace is required, use racket feeding as soon as possible.

TIME OF FLIGHT

Make sure the time of flight of the feed is sufficient for players to practice the skill. For example, as a player is moving more and more into a net shot, the feeder may need to move slightly further backwards to allow time for this whilst they learn the skill.

RATE OF FEED

Make sure the rate of delivery of the feed is slow enough that the players have sufficient time to:

- **Reflect on their previous attempt.**
- **Prepare properly for the next attempt.**

POWER OF THE FEED

The feeder has the shuttle, which is what the player is keen to hit. The feeder can help reinforce coaching by not delivering the shuttle until a particular aspect of technique has been demonstrated (e.g. correct grip, correct racket carriage).

If the feeder stares at the incorrect area, then this can be a very powerful way of encouraging the player to self-correct.

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Holding the Shuttle

An efficient way to hold a lot of shuttles is to cradle them in your non-throwing arm as shown in the picture opposite. Note how the shuttles are held with the cork of the shuttle pointing down.	
Shuttles can be delivered with the hand underneath the shuttle. In this case, make sure the fingers support the whole of the shuttle (including the cork) to give control.	
Shuttles can also be delivered with the hand over the shuttle.	

b) Hand feeding

ADVANTAGES OF HAND FEEDING	DISADVANTAGES OF HAND FEEDING
• Generally easier than racket feeding • Can give the player a lot of practice opportunities in a short space of time • Possible to mimic downward shots (over arm throw) and upwards shots (underarm throw) • With some training players can feed well • Overhead feeding can also benefit overhead hitting action	• Difficult to put pace on the shuttle • Player doesn't have opportunity to read shuttle coming off a racket • Hand feed to practice an overhead is quite difficult to do accurately • Hand feed to practice an overhead provides only a limited opportunity for player to pick up the flight of the shuttle • May need access to a lot of shuttles'

c) Underarm Hand Feed

Deliver underarm feeds with a long arm swing	
To gain height and accuracy for practicing overheads: • Stand with a wide stance • Bend the knees, then straighten • Throw from the shoulder, with long backswing • Place shuttle in air • Finish with hand high	

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d) "Flat" fast feed

"Flat" fast feeds are often easier to deliver with the hand over the top of the shuttle	 

e) Over arm Hand Feed

Use over arm hand feeding to mimic over arm strokes **Use over arm hand feeding to help develop good habits for your overhead hitting action, such as:** • **A sideways stance** • **Loading the rear leg** • **Weight transfer from rear to front leg (commit hip forwards)** • **Reach high**	

f) Racket Feeding – Multi-feed

Cradle the shuttle as previously described.

Take the first shuttle by the cork using the thumb and first finger.

Place the shuttle in front/to side of body. 'Cock' the wrist.

Strike the shuttle.

Racket Feeding –Rallying

Whilst multifeeding can be used productively in training, ultimately the sport is played with one shuttle, so make sure a considerable part of the training you deliver is with one shuttle. Vary the pace depending on the stage of learning of the player, for example when learning to play a smash off the body.Vary the height of the feed, for example giving more time when the player is learning a footwork pattern.

Slowly introduce an element of doubt. For example:

- **Player lifts straight.**
- **Coach dropshots straight.**
- **This continues until coach plays a clear.**
- **Player returns with a clear.**
- **Dropshots and lifts continue until coach plays next clear.**

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MODULE 3
COACHING CHILDREN

INTRODUCTION

When coaching children, it is important to recognize the position of power the coach has. The coach should use badminton as a way of making a positive impact on children, helping them to develop physically, emotionally, socially and intellectually. The coach can have a very strong influence on badminton development.

CHILD DEVELOPMENT AREA	BADMINTON EXAMPLE
PHYSICAL	Badminton can be used to help children maintain their health and fitness, establishing good habits that prepare them well for later in life.
EMOTIONAL	Badminton can be used to develop self-esteem, confidence and self-discipline.
SOCIAL	Children can develop friendships, teamwork and positive sporting behaviors through badminton.
INTELLECTUAL	Problem-solving skills can easily be developed though the tactical aspects of badminton.

CHILDREN MATURE AT DIFFERENT RATES

Coaches should be aware that children mature at different rates and this should influence how you coach them. For example, the table below indicates two players of the same age at different stages of physical, intellectual, emotional and social development. Note also the inclusion of a "training age".

	CHILD A	CHILD B
TRUE AGE	12	12
PHYSICAL AGE	Child A's parents are of above average height but Child A is very small compared to the average and not particularly strong	Child B is growing rapidly and is tall, although not particularly well-balanced
INTELLECTUAL AGE	Child A is more intelligent than many of his age group	Child B is of similar intelligence to other 12 year olds
EMOTIONAL AGE	Child A is emotionally quite immature. Child A gets upset easily when skills are not mastered straight away	Child B is emotionally mature, with good self-confidence/ self-control when competing and training
SOCIALLY	Child A is socially quite mature - works well within a small group of friends and with persuasion, has a positive attitude to working with others outside that group	Child B is socially very mature, makes friends easily and co-operates well in all different types of groups
TRAINING AGE	Child A has been training regularly for 1 year	Child B has been training regularly for 3 years

It is an interesting exercise to look at the profile of the above children and think how the information you have about them might make you coach each child in different ways.

IMPORTANCE OF THE 'GROWTH SPURT'

Somewhere between the ages of 10 and 16 children will experience a period of rapid growth. This is known as the 'growth spurt'. Important facts about the growth spurt that can influence coaching are:

- **Some children will experience the start of the growth spurt earlier (10 would be early) or later (14 would be late).**
- **Girls tend to experience the growth spurt earlier than boys.**

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- **The 2-3 years prior to the growth spurt is a period where great improvements can be made in the development of sporting skills, due to the relative stability of the child's body and the increased maturity of their nervous system.**
- **During the growth spurt, children may experience balance and co-ordination challenges. Reassurance that this phase is temporary is necessary.**
- **Children may be more vulnerable to injury during the growth spurt due to:**
    - **reduced balance and co-ordination means falls or incorrect technique could occur;**
    - **growth plates in bones made of softer cartilage are potential sites for injury; losses in flexibility.**
    - **Coaches can help players during the growth spurt by:**
- **being patient;**
- **encouraging good technique;**
- **avoiding excessive repetition in practices that could lead to more overuse injuries;**
- **encouraging flexibility;**
- **Wherever possible, playing on appropriate surfaces.**

ADAPTING THE SPORT

One way in which children have fun when they begin a sport is through experiencing success. This is not necessarily the success of winning, but the success of learning new skills in an effective manner.

Badminton can be adapted in a number of ways to help young children learn skills more effectively, and these are listed below.

ADAPTATION	ADVANTAGES
SHORTER RACKETS	• Easier to control a shorter lever • The object being struck is not so far from the mid-line of the body, which children will find easier
LOWER NET	• Strokes around the net can be played with the same shape as the child would be expected to produce as an adult (e.g. net shot around shoulder height) • Children more likely to hit down
SLOW THE OBJECT BEING STRUCK	• In the early stages, hitting balloons allows children to experience success and have time to think about grips, grip changes and the shapes of strokes (e.g. forearm rotation)
ALTERING THE RULES	• Occasionally altering the rules can help players acquire a skill more effectively. Examples could be: ○ alternating serves so both children get an equal amount of serving practice when playing against each other; ○ allowing second serves so children get "another go" if they are not successful at first; ○ giving bonus points for winning a rally with a particular stroke

SUMMARY

These are key points in this module:

- **When coaching children it is important to recognize the coach has a highly responsible role. A badminton coach can make a positive contribution to a child's physical, emotional, intellectual and social development.**
- **Children mature at different rates and it is important to take this into consideration, adapting your coaching accordingly.**

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- **Older children experience a growth spurt which can affect their enjoyment and progress. Careful attention by the coach can assist the child in maintaining their enjoyment, reduce the chance of injury and support their further development.**

MODULE 4

PERFORMANCE FACTOR 1 TECHNICAL (MOVEMENT SKILLS)

01. INTRODUCTION

Badminton is a high speed sport played on a relatively small court against an opponent who will, amongst other things, be trying to force you off-balance and out of position. For these reasons, badminton players need to be able to move quickly and efficiently if they are to compete well within the sport .

02. COMPONENTS OF BADMINTON MOVEMENTS

If you watch a high level badminton game and focus on the movements performed by the player, you will see the same movements being repeated many times over. These movement components are listed below:

- **Split-step**
- **Running steps**
- **Chasse**
- **Cross behind**
- **Hop/pivot**
- **Lunge**
- **Jump**
- **Landing**

Training these movement components in isolation is useful, but eventually they need to be integrated so that those players can flow around the court effectively. A useful way to put these components together is in a model known as the "movement cycle" (shown over). The movement cycle has four parts:

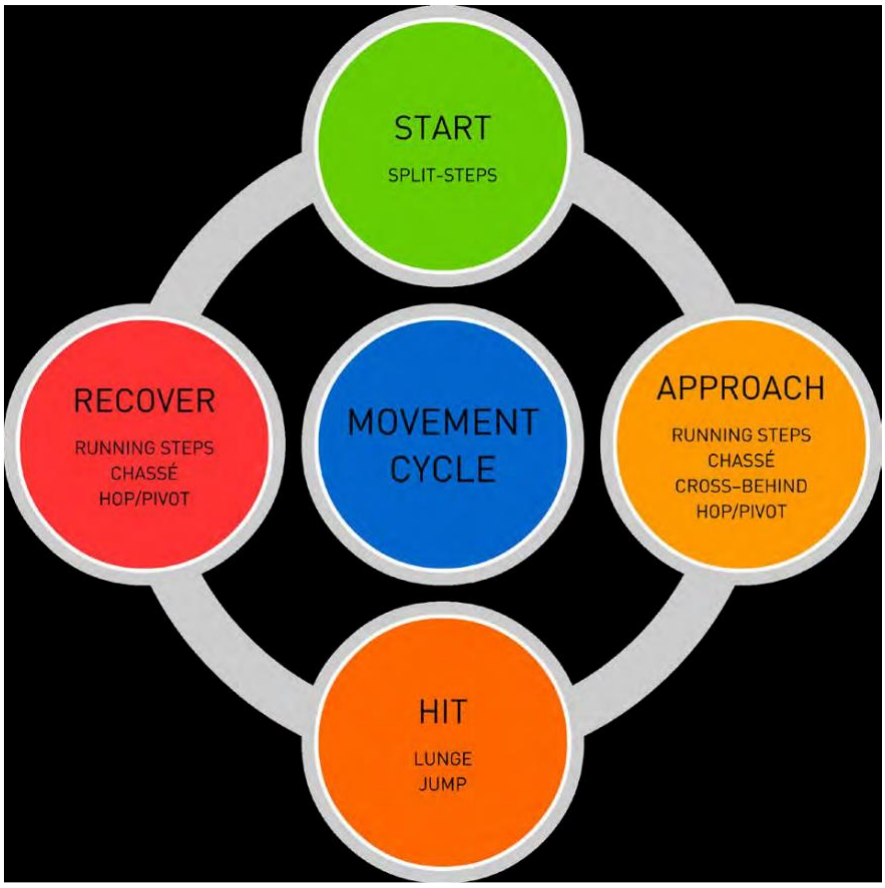
- **START, which happens in response to your opponent's hit and allows you to move off towards the shuttle;**

- **APPROACH, which includes the methods you would then use to travel across the court towards the shuttle;**

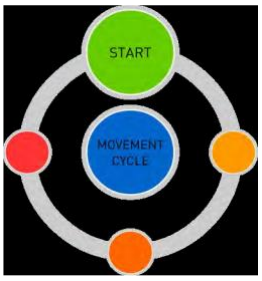
- **HIT, or more precisely the movements your body performs as you hit;**

- **RECOVERY, involving methods you would use to travel in a direction that anticipates your opponent's reply.**

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Note the common movements in APPROACH and RECOVER.



03. SPLIT STEP

WHAT TO COACH

The split step is used to help you:

- **link movements together;**
- **change direction;**
- **move off quickly in response to your opponent's shot.**

DESCRIPTION OF MOVEMENT



A shallow jump off the ground just before your opponent Strikes the shuttle. This allows the body to rebound off the floor and move off more quickly on landing.



. A widening of the base and bending of the knees on landing. The widened base/knee bend helps the player stay balanced. The landing occurs with or after the opponent has struck the shuttle.



Upper body relaxed and between the feet, with slight bend forwards at hips. Keep the upper body between the feet helps with balance. Use an explosive push-off from the ground on landing and make the ground contact time short so you move off quickly.



Split-steps can occur all around the court as it depends where you are when your opponent strikes the shuttle.

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A split-step can be performed with the feet side by side;



left foot leading.



right foot leading.



COACHING HINTS AND TIPS

Run down the sports hall performing a split-step at given intervals. Use lines to guide your split-step. For the purposes of maintaining balance it is possibly best to coach the split step as a two footed landing. In reality however, one foot nearly always lands before the other. The feet that a land first governs which direction the player will move off:

- **Left lands first, move to right.**
- **Right foot first, move to left.**
- **Front foot first, move back.**
- **Back foot first, move forwards.**

Note that there is no split step that can be performed which will allow the player to move off equally in all directions.

With experience players learn to land their split step in a way that allows them to cover the most likely replies.

04. APPROACH AND RECOVERY



WHAT TO COACH

Many of the movements used to approach the shuttle are the same as those used to recover having struck the shuttle. It is beneficial to be able to perform movements forwards, backwards and sideways.

DESCRIPTION OF MOVEMENT

1. Running steps



Forward



backwards

COACHING HINTS AND TIPS

- When running forwards:
  - the feet hit the ground heel then toe;
  - strides tend to be longer.
- When running backwards:
  - stay on your toes;
  - strides tend to be quick and short.

2. Chassé

- One foot chases the other but never quite catches it.
- Chassés can be performed with feet at 90o to each other.
- Chassés can be performed with feet parallel to each other (side steps).
- If done well the player will skim quickly across the ground.

COACHING HINTS AND TIPS

- Encourage short ground contact times, as though the ground is hot.
- Pick a point on the wall ahead to concentrate on. If the point on the wall stays “still” then the player’s head will be staying level, helping that player to skim across the ground.



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• Chassés normally occur singly or in pairs, so keep this in mind when practicing. Chasséing long distances (e.g. the diagonals of the court) is a slow method and should be discouraged.

3. Cross –behind

• The non-racket leg passes behind the racket leg.



It is very rare for more than one cross-behind Movement to performed at a time.

4. Hop/Pivot

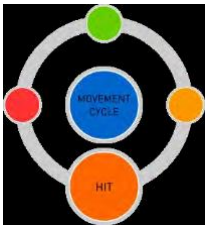
• Hops are little jumps that take off on one foot then land on the same foot. Often in badminton this hop is combined with a pivoting movement.





Hops can be about gaining height, however they are often used to cover distance, particularly when a hop and pivot is combined.

05. MOVEMENTS ASSOCIATED WITH HITTING



WHAT TO COACH

Movements associated with hitting.

DESCRIPTION

LUNGING • Lunging is in effect a large stride. The pictures to the right show where and when the lunge is used on The court

• Most lunging is done on the racket leg, but some non-racket leg lunging does happen.



At the net when performing net kill, net shots and lift



in the mid-court, when the shuttle is at the side of the



in rear-court when the shuttle is behind the striking player

COACHING HINTS AND TIPS

• The lead foot points towards the shuttle.
• Lead leg knee and foot point of contact in the same direction to protect knee/ankle joints.
• Turn out rear-foot to help with balance and range of movement.
• Bend rear knee to reduce strain on knee.
• Extend rear arm for balance

JUMPING BASICS

Jumping can be defined as a movement involving an extended flight phase where both feet are off ground.

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Jumps can be split into the preparation, flight and landing phases.

1 • Bend at the ankles, knees and hips to pre-stretch leg muscles and help in force production.
• At the same time, swing the arms back and downwards.
• Keep chest up.
2 • Swing the arms forwards and upwards.
• Extend at the hips, knees and ankles.
• Direct force downwards into the ground.
3 • Extend all joints fully.
4 • Land on balls of feet first.
• Bend ankles, knees and hips on landing to absorb force.
• Keep chest up.

COACHING HINTS AND TIPS

. An effective squat movement is a worthwhile movement to learn as it helps jumping technique.
• Feet pointing forwards, heels down throughout.
• Sit back, bending at the ankles, knees and hips.
• Chest up.
• Aim to get the back and shins

JUMPING VARIATIONS

Apart from a basic jump involving taking off and landing, a number of other variations are possible.

Two feet to to one	two feet to one . foot	one foot to two feet	one foot to one foot (same foot hopping)	one foot other foot (bounding)

COACHING HINTS AND TIPS

All jumps can be performed in 3 directions:
• Side to side;
• Forwards and backwards;
• Rotationally.

0 6. MOVEMENT PATTERNS



WHAT TO COACH

MOVEMENT PATTERNS

In order to move around the court effectively it is necessary to put together the movement components in specific patterns. These patterns can be quite personal and often depend on the exact situation. This section therefore contains some common patterns, but not all those that can occur.

DESCRIPTION

Move to backhand forecourt.

Split step → chasse → lunge → step back or chasse

Split step → running step → lunge → chasse/step back

Split step → hop/pivot around non-racket leg → lunge → chasse/step back
Non-racket leg lead

COACHING HINTS AND TIPS

• Promote short ground contact time on chassé.
• Make sure lunge has good range of movement, with a phase when the front leg is straight.
• Promote good upper body posture. Split step.

Move to backhand rearcourt.

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Split step → pivot/hop around Non racket leg → jump and turn in the air strike the shuttle while Off the ground → chasse or running

- Make sure the pivot/hop covers some distance so helps the player to move into the corner of the court

Split step → backwards running steps → jump and turn in the air strike the shuttle while off the ground → chasse/ step back

- The running steps backwards should follow a slightly curved path, helping the player get side-on to the shuttle when they hit the shuttle.

Split step → chasse back Turn your back on the net → half-lunch → pivot/spin rapidly back in court

- The more under pressure you are, the deeper the lunge becomes when you are hitting.

Move to forehand forecourt.

Split step Racket leg leads → chasse → lunge → chasse and/or step back

Split step → running step → lunge → chasse and /or step back

Split step racket leg lead → cross- behind → lunge → chasse and/ or step back

- Promote short ground contact time on chasse.
- Make sure lunge has good range of movement, with a phase when the front leg is straight.
- Promote good upper body posture.

Move to forehand rearcourt

Split step → cross-behind → lunge → chasse or pivot

Split step → chasse → jump out -strike While in the air → chasse

Split step → chasse back → jump out turn in the Air -strike shuttle while off the ground → chasse/ running step

COACHING HINTS AND TIPS

- The more under pressure you are, the deeper the lunge becomes hitting
- This tends to be a straight line movement, moving directly into the forehand rearcourt corner
- The split step and chasse tend to create an arcing shape, allowing the player to get more side-on to the shuttle.

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MODULE5
PERFORMANCE FACTOR 1 TECHNICAL (HITTING SKILLS)

INTRODUCTION

This section will cover: Biomechanical principles.
This looks briefly at the importance of bending and straightening, rotating and force generation when striking a badminton shuttle.

CATCHING, THROWING AND STRIKING SKILLS

Prior to learning how to strike a shuttle, children need to acquire catching, throwing and striking skills. This allows them to develop:

- effective tracking skills (watching an approaching object) ;
- hand-eye-foot co-ordination, allowing them to catch successfully;
- throwing skills, which underpin hitting skills that are developed later;
- hitting skills with the hand.

GRIPS

Once basic sending and receiving skills have been established, the introduction of a racket means that children have to learn to grip the racket correctly in a number of different situations.

STROKES

This section will introduce a wide range of strokes used in badminton. For each stroke, there will be guidance on:
- where the shot is played from and to;

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• when you use the shot;
• why you use the shot;
• what the stroke looks like;
• how to practice it.

For each stroke the aim should be to:

• make sure players appreciate that strokes tactical usage;
• promote technical correctness;
• provide different levels of practice so players can succeed whatever their current playing level;
• provide practices that are fun are motivational.

HITTING TECHNIQUES TO CHILDREN/BEGINNERS

Although there is no absolutely definite order in which strokes should be introduced, coaches may find the follow guidelines useful when working with beginners/young children.
• Backhand serve.
• Backhand forecourt strokes, including lifts, net kills and net shots.
• Forehand forecourt strokes, including lifts, net kills and net shots.
• Forehand high serves.
• Backhand midcourt strokes (drives, blocks and pushes).
• Forehand midcourt strokes (drives, blocks and pushes).
• Forehand and backhand overhead pulled dropshots.
• Forehand overheads.
The rationale behind this suggested order is:
• Backhands tend to be emphasised first because the actions are generally short and easier to time.
• Forecourt strokes are mainly underarm, which is an easier skill to learn than overhead hitting.

INTRODUCTION OF HITTING TECHNIQUES – CHILDREN /BEGINNERS

Although there is no absolutely definite order in which strokes should be introduced, coaches may find the follow guidelines useful when working with beginners/young children.
1. Backhand serve.
2. Backhand forecourt strokes, including lifts, net kills and net shots.
3. Forehand forecourt strokes, including lifts, net kills and net shots.
4. Forehand high serves.
5. Backhand midcourt strokes (drives, blocks and pushes).
6. Forehand midcourt strokes (drives, blocks and pushes).
7. Forehand overheads.
8. Forehand and backhand overhead pulled dropshots.
The rationale behind this suggested order is:
• Backhands tend to be emphasised first because the actions are generally short and easier to time
• Forecourt strokes are mainly underarm, which is the easiest starting point and it also prepares the players for overhead hitting and practice.

. BIOMECHANICAL PRINCIPLES

There are four key areas that underpin hitting skills in badminton. These are:

BACKSWINGS

To generate significant force, strokes require a backswing. BACKSWINGs stretch muscles. Those muscles then recoil rapidly in response to that stretch, adding power to the forward swing of the stroke.





COORDINATION: BIG MUSCLES TO SMALL MUSCLES

Hitting the shuttle in badminton is the result of muscle forces producing a series of co-ordinated joint movements in the body.
The final force generated is greatest when the forces have started with big muscles and finished with smaller muscles.





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ROTATION

Rotation of the whole body.



Rotation of the upper arm



External Rotation



Internal Rotation

Rotation of the lower arm.



Lower arm: supination (external rotation)



Lower arm: pronation (internal rotat

BENDING AND STRAIGHTENING

Bending and straightening of joints is also an important part of stroke production. Bending forms an element of the backswing and straightening is involved in the forwards swing as you reach for the shuttle to strike it.



Bent arm



Straighten arm

04. CATCHING AND THROWING

Working on throwing and catching helps children develop the skill to:

- watch an object carefully when in flight;
- put their body and hands in the correct position to intercept that object.

These skills underpin the eventual development of hitting skills. The table below explains a number of practices that can be undertaken to develop throwing and catching skills.

ROLLING AND STOPPING

Young children can gain from rolling a ball to each other as this:

- Helps them learn the importance of watching an object travelling towards them and how this can help them collect that object successfully.
- Allows them to experiment with applying different levels of force so the ball can travel different distances successfully.

UNDER ARM THROWS

- Throw different types and weights of objects.
- Experiment with the feel of pushing, flicking and throwing objects, including shuttles, to compare the different levels of control and flight paths that can be achieved.
- Try both forehand throws (with the palm of the hand leading) and backhand throws (with the back of the hand leading).
- Devise games involving underarm throwing, such as underarm throwing golf where a number of different underarm throws are used to deliver a shuttle into a target (e.g. a hoop).

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UNDERARM CATCHES

Encourage watching the approaching object carefully and catching with palms down (little fingers together). Begin with catches in directly in front of the body and then progress to:

- catches on either side of body;
- one-handed catches.

OVERHEAD THROWS

Encouraging children to learn effective overhead throwing techniques is very important, since this action is the basis of forehand overhead hitting. Progress this skill by working in pairs and throwing:

- seated and cross legged;
- kneeling on both knees with bottom against heels;
- kneeling on both knees with bottom off heels;
- kneeling on one knee (right knee if a right hander);
- stood square on);
- stood side on with feet together;
- stood side on with feet apart;
- stood with feet together, take a step back and use drive from rear leg to help throw;
- stood with feet together, take a step back and use drive from rear leg to help throw. Step through immediately after throw delivered;
- stood with feet together, take a step back and use drive from rear leg to help throw. Take off as you throw, rotate and land.

This helps children to appreciate how to use their body to generate forces when throwing.

OVERARM CATCHES

Encourage catching with palms up (thumbs together). Begin with catches directly in front of the body and then progress to:

- catches on either side of body;
- one-handed catches.

GAMES FOR THROWING AND CATCHING

These are fun games that encourage the development of throwing and catching skills

INTERCEPTION GAMES

- Dividing a group into two teams of no more than five.
- Working within an agreed area, each team aims to keep possession of a weighted shuttlecock.
- Contact between players is not allowed and once a player has caught the object they cannot move off that spot until they have thrown the object to another member of their team.
- This game can be used to improve overhead throwing by building rules that encourage good technique. For example, you lose possession if the overhead thrower does not get side-on before they throw.

THROWMINTON

- Two players can compete against each other using a weighted shuttle on half a court.
- The object is thrown backwards and forwards across the net, with the aim being to land the object in your opponent's court or force them to make an error (e.g. into the net).
- Once the object has been caught the player must throw the shuttle back from where they caught it.
- If the shuttle is in the front half of the court it needs to be returned with an underarm throw. If caught in the rearcourt the shuttle should be returned with an overarm throw.
- This game can be used to improve overhead throwing by building rules that encourage good technique. For example, when throwing overhead the player must rotate in the air as they hit (kicking through). If they do not they lose the point.
- Team versions of this game on a full court can be devised by the players.

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DEVELOPING STRIKING SKILLS

Catching and throwing involves the hands directly interacting with an object. Striking with a racket requires the player to adjust so the object being struck interacts with the racket face, which is some distance from the hand. Practices therefore should help the player to make this transition.

HITTING WITH THE HAND

Hitting with the hand is a development of throwing and catching. It requires you to watch the flying object carefully and adjust your feet and hands so the hand can strike that object successfully.

Working alone and using the palm of the hand, strike a soft ball or balloon in the air. Experiment hitting with one hand, then the other, then alternate. Experiment with keeping the object in the air whilst doing tricks (e.g. get down on the floor and back up again).



Working alone and using the back of the hand, strike a soft ball or balloon in the air. Experiment hitting with one hand, then the other, then alternate. Experiment with keeping the object in the air whilst doing tricks (e.g. get down on the floor and back up again).



Working alone keep a soft ball or balloon in the air using the palms and backs of both hands. Try to make up a sequence of tricks.



Holding a soft ball or balloon above your head, reach up with the other hand and rotate the arm so you can see your palm.



Then strike the ball out of your hand using your palm. Promote a follow through that finishes so the player can see the back of their hand (forearm pronated).
Using a soft ball or balloon, rally with a partner using the palms and the backs of the hand. This can be done seated or standing.



HITTING WITH A VERY SHORT GRIP

Hitting with a very short grip helps players achieve success because the object they wish to strike is still relatively close to the hand when it is struck.





- Holding a racket near the “T” with the back of The hand upwards

keep a balloon, soft or shuttle in the air using forearm rotation



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.

• Holding a racket near the “T” with the first finger below and along the frame.

keep a balloon, soft or shuttle in the air using forearm rotation



. • Holding a racket near the “T” with the first finger below and along the frame.
.touch a shuttle with the strings of the racket

• Take the racket head back using forearm rotation.



• Strike the shuttle using forearm rotation (the player can see the back of their hand).



HITTING WITH A LONG GRIP

For training exercises using a long grip, refer to the section on “grips”.

GRIPS – INTRODUCTION

To play badminton effectively, the ability to grip the racket appropriately in a large variety of situations is essential. The following guidelines are useful when coaching grips in badminton:

- Grips should be relaxed. This gives various advantages, including easier grip changes, improved power, reduced fatigue and increased deception
- A tightening of the grip will naturally occur on impact. This tightening is more apparent in powerful strokes (e.g. drives) than soft shots (e.g. net shots).
- Grips need continual adjustment depending on whether the shuttle is:
  - in front, at the side or behind you;
  - on the backhand and forehand side.
- Grips can also be long and short
  - Long grips are better for reach and also for power. For example, most rear-court strokes will use a long grip.

when using the long grip, the bottom of the hand will be resting gently against the base of the racket handle, which is widened slightly to prevent the hand slipping off the racket.





- Short grips are often used for quick movements or when more control is required.





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A) BASIC GRIP - WHAT TO COACH

The basic grip is used to play strokes where the shuttle is level with the player, on both the forehand and backhand sides.

The thumb and first finger of the hand creates a “v” shape on the racket handle. The position of the bottom of the “v” is important and is shown in the illustrations below. The basic grip is also called the “v” grip

.

BASIC GRIP: LEVEL WITH PLAYER



BASIC GRIP: CLOSE UP



BASIC GRIP: THE POSITION OF THE BOTTOM OF THE “V”

INTRODUCTORY PRACTICES FOR “V” GRIP – HOW TO COACH.

- Keep the shuttle up in the air as many times as possible with the palm of the hand upwards.
- Keep the shuttle up in the air as many times as possible with the palm of the hand upwards. Between each shot, pass the racket around the body once, twice or three times!
- Keep the shuttle up in the air as many times as possible with the palm of the hand upwards. Between each shot, pass the racket:
  - under one leg;
  - under one leg, then the other.
- Keep the shuttle up in the air as many times as possible with the palm of the hand upwards. Strike the shuttle under one leg, under the other leg or round the back.
- Working with a partner, keep the shuttle up in the air as many times as possible with the palm of the hand upwards. Players take alternate shots.
- Working with a partner, strike the shuttle backwards and forwards across a line to each other with the palm of the hand ‘leading’.
- Strike a suspended object (balloon, fluff ball, shuttle) above the head using a basic grip. Use a throwing action and the aim is to hit the shuttle above/slightly in front of the striking shoulder (right shoulder for a right hander).

B) THUMB GRIP - WHAT TO COACH

The thumb grip is used to play basic backhand strokes in front of the body. Examples include net shots, net lifts, net kills, backhand serves and backhand drives (when struck in front of the body). The

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thumb is placed at the back of the racket handle, with a slight gap between the hand and the racket handle.

THUMB GRIP: LONG SHOT



THUMB GRIP: CLOSE-UP



THUMB GRIP: THUMB POSITION

THUMB GRIP - HOW TO COACH

INTRODUCTORY PRACTICES FOR THE THUMB GRIP

- Establish the thumb grip on top of the racket handle.
- Turn the hand over so the knuckles are upwards.
- Keep the shuttle up in the air as many times as possible with the back of the hand leading (thumb committed under the racket handle).
- Keep the shuttle up in the air as many times as possible with the back of the hand leading (thumb held firmly under the racket handle). Between each shot, pass the racket around the body once, twice or three times!
- Keep the shuttle up in the air as many times as possible with the back of the hand leading (thumb under the racket handle). Between each shot, pass the racket:
    - under one leg;
    - under one leg, then the other;
- Keep the shuttle up in the air as many times as possible with the back of the hand leading (thumb placed under the racket handle). Between each stroke, go down on one knee, the other knee, sit down, lie down, and then get back up.
- Working with a partner, keep the shuttle up in the air as many times as possible with the back of the hand leading (thumb placed under the racket handle). Players take alternate shots.
- Working with a partner, strike the shuttle backwards and forwards across a line to each other with the back of the hand leading (thumb placed under the racket handle).

C) CORNER GRIP - WHAT TO COACH

The corner grip is an alternative used for backhand strokes when the shuttle is level with or slightly behind the player. These strokes include backhand drives and blocks (when the shuttle is at the side of the body), backhand clears, backhand dropshots and backhand smashes

.

CORNER GRIP: LONG SHOT



CORNER GRIP: CLOSE-UP



CORNER GRIP: THUMB POSITION

INTRODUCTORY PRACTICES FOR THE CORNER GRIP – HOW TO COACH

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With your back to the net, strike a suspended object from slightly behind the body, either at shoulder height or above head height.

With your back to the net, strike a hand fed shuttle from slightly behind the body, either at shoulder height or above head height

.

Racket feed a shuttle so that the player can strike the shuttle from slightly behind the body with their back to the net.

D) PANHANDLE GRIP - WHAT TO COACH

The panhandle grip is used for:

- backhand strokes when the shuttle is well behind the player (e.g. backhand dropshots);
- forehand strokes when the shuttle is well in front of the player (e.g. net kills).

PANHANDLE GRIP: LONG SHOT



PANHANDLE GRIP: CLOSE UP



PANHANDLE GRIP: POSITION OF BOTTOM OF "V" SHAPE WHERE THUMB AND FIRST FINGER MEET

INTRODUCTORY PRACTICES FOR THE PANHANDLE GRIP – HOW TO COACH

For panhandle practices at the forehand net, refer to practices for net kills.
For panhandle practices in the deep backhand, refer to pulled backhand dropshots.

E) INTRODUCTORY PRACTICES FOR GRIP CHANGES – HOW TO COACH

Keep a shuttle in the air 5 times using a "basic grip" (forehand) then another 5 times using a thumb grip (backhand). Gradually reduce this to 4, 3, 2 and 1 hits so you finish alternating your grip after each shot.

Strike a hand fed shuttle back to a practice partner. Do this 5 times with a basic grip on the forehand, then 5 times with a thumb grip on the backhand. Gradually reduce this to 4, 3, 2 and 1 hits so you finish alternating your grip after each shot.

Use a basic grip and a forehand overhead action to strike a suspended shuttle, then run forwards and strike a hand fed shuttle using a thumb grip.

Use a basic grip and a forehand overhead action to strike a suspended shuttle, then turn and use a corner grip to strike the same object using a backhand overhead hit.

Use a panhandle grip to strike a hand fed shuttle down at the net (forehand net kill). Change to a thumb grip and strike a hand fed shuttle down at the net (backhand net kill).

. BASIC STROKES

This section will introduce a wide range of strokes used in badminton. For each stroke, there will be guidance on:

- where the shot is played from and to;
- when you use the shot;
- why you use the shot;
- what the stroke looks like (including preparation, backswing, forward swing and follow-through)
- how to practice it;
- hints, tips and variations (including spins, slices and opportunity for deception).

A color-coded table is used throughout the strokes section.

WHERE STROKE GOES WHEN YOU USE THE STROKE WHY YOU USE THE STROKE

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WHAT THE STROKE LOOKS LIK

PREPARATION BACKSWING FORWARD SWING FOLLOW THROUGH

HOW TO INTRODUCE THE STROKES
HINTS, TIPS AND VARIATIONS

A) DECEPTION

Being able to trick your opponent is a major part of badminton. Where-ever possible strokes should be made to look the same as other related shots to keep your opponent guessing. This will be reflected in the technical information given throughout.

B) HITTING AND MOVEMENT

Although this section concentrates on the actual striking of the shuttle, it is important to integrate movement into the exercises as soon as possible. Refer to the section on Skill Development for ideas on integrating hitting and movement together, placing particular attention on the use of chaining.

C) STRAIGHT AND CROSS-COURT STROKES

Strokes can also be hit straight or cross-court. Cross-courts strokes can be achieved by:

- taking the shuttle out in front of the body;
- changing your grip to alter the position of the racket face;
- bending the wrist to alter the position of the racket face;
- slicing the shuttle.

. INTRODUCTION TO SERVING

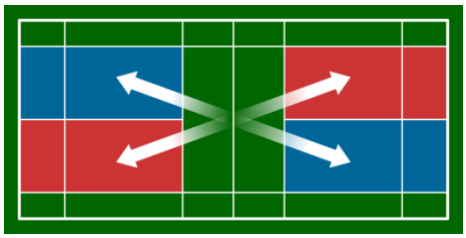
Because of the laws of the game, the server is restricted in what they can do with regards to serving. The laws relevant to serving are listed below.

Note this is correct at the time of writing and coaches should keep up to date with any changes to the laws of the game via the BWF website.

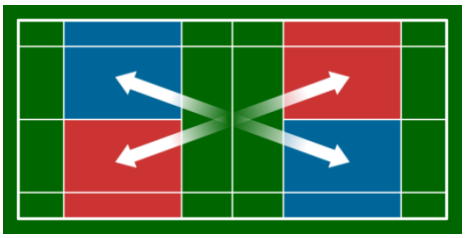
In a correct service:

- neither side shall cause undue delay to the delivery of the service once the server and the receiver are ready for the service. On completion of the backward movement of server's racket head, any delay in the start of the service, shall be considered to be an undue delay;
- the server and the receiver shall stand within diagonally opposite service courts without touching the boundary lines of these service courts;

Singles service boxes (long and thin)



Doubles service boxes (short and fat)



- some part of both feet of the server and the receiver shall remain in contact with the surface of the court in a stationary position from the start of the service until the service is delivered;
- the server's racket shall initially hit the base of the shuttle;
- the whole shuttle shall be below the server's waist at the instant of being hit by the server's racket. The waist shall be considered to be an imaginary line round the body, level with the lowest part of the server's bottom rib;
- the shaft of the server's racket at the instant of hitting the shuttle shall be pointing in a downward

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direction;
- the movement of the server's racket shall continue forwards from the start of the service until the service is delivered;
- the flight of the shuttle shall be upwards from the server's racket to pass over the net so that, if not intercepted, it shall land in the receiver's service court (i. e. on or within the boundary lines), and in attempting to serve, the server shall not miss the shuttle.

Once the players are ready for the service, the first forward movement of the server's racket head shall be the start of the service.

Once started, the service is delivered when the shuttle is hit by the server's racket or, in attempting to serve, the server misses the shuttle.

The server shall not serve before the receiver is ready. However, the receiver shall be considered to have been ready if a return of the service is attempted.

In doubles, during the delivery of service, the partners may take up any positions within their respective courts, which do not unsight the opposing server or receiver.

Backhand Flick Serve

WHERE THE SHUTTLE GOES

To follow the laws of the game, the shuttle must travel from one service box to the diagonally opposite service box. Singles flick serves can go to the back line. Doubles flick serves must land within the inner doubles service line.

WHEN WE USE IT

You use backhand flick serves at the start of the rally, hitting from a defensive/neutral situation.

WHY WE USE IT

You aim to force your opponent backwards and make them off-balance by making them believe you are going to low serve.

WHAT TO COACH

PREPARE

- Stance can vary, but most common is with the racket foot forwards, close to the "T" on the court.
- Use a short, relaxed thumb grip (for doubles).
- Place the racket out in front of the body.
- Place shuttle on racket



BACKSWING

- Bend wrist and rotate forearm slightly.
- Take the racket back a short distance.
- Open the racket face.





FORWARD SWING

- Accelerate the racket head forwards.
- Flick the shuttle out of the hand

.

FOLLOW THROUGH

- Momentum of racket continues arm rotation.



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HOW TO COACH - INTRODUCTORY PRACTICES FOR A BACKHAND FLICK SERVE

Strike the shuttle from the hand into a target area (hoop, bucket etc.) without a net. Make sure the distance is sufficient to encourage a flicking action.
In small teams, use a backhand flick serving technique into target areas, with each area achieving a score (e.g. one point =large target, 5 points = medium target, 10 points = small target). Having struck the shuttle, run forwards to collect the shuttle and return to the back of the queue. Count up your own score to compare to your team mates, or add up your team score to compare to other teams after a set time (e.g. 3 minutes). Make sure the distance is sufficient to encourage a flicking action.

Two players stand on opposite sides of the net. They place a target close to the rear service line of their service box. The two players then have alternate backhand flick serves, scoring how many times they hit the target. After a set time (e.g. 3 minutes) scores are compared to find a winner. If it's a draw hit the shuttle in the air and which way it points is the winner. Winners move up the hall, losers move down the hall to take on a new opponent.

Play a game where only backhand flick serves are allowed.

Consider
:

- allowing players two attempts, so if they hit the first serve out/in the net then they get another go;
- rotate serves, so everyone gets an equal amount of serving practice;
- the receiver stands in different positions and carries their racket in different positions. The server must adjust where they place their flick serve (e.g. wide, to centre etc.).

HINTS, TIPS AND VARIATIONS

- Make flick serves look like your low serve to confuse your opponent.
- In singles backhand flick serves can be delivered with a longer grip and deeper in the court.

b. Backhand Low Serve

WHERE THE SHUTTLE GOES

To follow the laws of the game, the shuttle must travel from one service box to the diagonally opposite service box. singles flick serves can go to back line Backhand low serves pass close to the top of the net and land at the front of the diagonally opposite service box.

WHEN WE USE IT
Used in doubles and men's singles to start the rally, from a defensive/neutral situation.

WHY WE USE IT

- Restrict your opponent's opportunity to attack.
- Help create attacking opportunities for yourself.

WHAT TO COACH

PREPARE



- Stance can vary, but most common is with the racket foot forwards, close to the "T" on the court.
- Use a short, relaxed thumb grip (for doubles).
- Place the racket out in front of the body.
- Place shuttle on racket.



BACKSWING

- Take the racket back a short distance.
- Open racket face slightly.

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FORWARD SWING

• Push through the shuttle.
• Strike the shuttle out of the hand.



FOLLOW THROUGH

• Continue pushing action.
• Bring racket up to threaten service reply
.

HOW TO COACH - INTRODUCTORY PRACTICES FOR A BACKHAND LOW SERVE

Strike the shuttle from the hand into a target area (hoop, bucket etc.) without a net.In small teams, use a backhand low serving technique into target areas, with each area achieving a score (e.g. one point =large target, 5 points = medium target, 10 points = small target). Having struck the shuttle, run forwards to collect the shuttle and return to the back of the queue. Count up your own score to compare to your team mates, or add up your team score to compare to other teams after a set time (e.g. 3 minutes).

Two players stand on opposite sides of the net. They place a target close to the front service line of their service box. The two players then have alternate backhand serves, scoring how many times they hit the target. After a set time (e.g. 3 minutes) scores are compared to find a winner. If it's a draw hit the shuttle in the air and which way it points is the winner. Winners move up the hall, losers move down to take on a new opponent

.Play a game where only low backhand serves are allowed.

Consider:

• allowing players two attempts, so if they hit the first serve out/in the net then they get another go;
• rotate serves, so everyone gets an equal amount of serving practice;
• the receiver stands in different positions and carries their racket in different positions. The server must adjust where they place their low serve (e.g. wide, to centre, at the player etc.).

HINTS, TIPS AND VARIATIONS

• Make low serves look like your flick serve to confuse your opponent.
• Serve mainly to the centre in doubles, so you can cover returns to both sides equally. However also develop the skill to vary serves along the front service line to keep your opponent guessing and
disrupt their favorite returns.
• Serve slightly further into court in singles to restrict the opportunity for your opponent to play tight shots to the net.
• In singles backhand low serves can be delivered with a longer grip and deeper in the court.

c. Forehand Flick Serve

WHERE THE SHUTTLE GOES

To follow the laws of the game, the shuttle must travel from one service box to the diagonally opposite service box. Singles flick serves can go to the back line.

WHEN WE USE IT

You use forehand flick serves at the start of the rally when you are in a defensive/neutral situation. They are mainly used in women's singles, but can be used in any event.

WHY WE USE IT

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You aim to force your opponent backwards and make them off-balance by making them believe you are going to low serve.

WHAT TO COACH



PREPARE

- Sideways stance within service box.
- Basic grip.
- Racket and shuttle in elevated position.
- Weight on rear leg.



BACKSWING

- Begin transfer of weight forwards.
- Drop the shuttle to the side/in front
- Lower the racket.
- Bend the wrist and supinate the forearm.



FORWARD SWING

- Continue weight transfer to front foot.
- Swing racket forwards.
- Accelerate racket head by pronating forearm and straightening wrist.
- Strike hard through the shuttle – in front and to side of body.



FOLLOW THROUGH

- Momentum carries racket through high and long.

HOW TO COACH - INTRODUCTORY PRACTICES FOR A FOREHAND FLICK SERVE

Forehand serves are slightly more challenging than backhand serves because they involve striking a dropping shuttle. This challenge is addressed in the practices described below In order to experience immediate success:

- encourage players to use a basic grip;
- place the shuttle onto the strings of the racket. (The player will need to bend forwards slightly to achieve this);
- create a short backswing by cocking the wrist;
- flick the shuttle out of the hand.
- In small teams (e.g. 3's), each player carries a shuttle in their non-racket hand and waits behind the back line of the court.
- In turn the players run forwards to where a shuttle tube is placed on the court. From an upright standing position players aim to drop the shuttle into the tube.
- If they miss the tube they pick up the shuttle and return to the back of the queue. Once all shuttles are in the tube, it is emptied and the team carries on trying to improve their score.
- The game finishes at an agreed set time

.

Putting the previous two practices together, players aim to gradually:

- Increase the distance the shuttle is dropped;
- increase the length of swing;
- increase the amount of weight transfer.

Two players stand on opposite sides of the net. They place a target close to the rear service line of their service box. The two players then have alternate forehand flick serves, scoring how many times they hit the target. After a set time (e.g. three minutes) scores are compared to find a winner. If it's a draw hit the shuttle in the air and which way it points is the winner. Winners move up the hall, losers move down the hall to take on a new opponent. Play a game where only forehand flick serves are allowed. Consider:

- allowing players two attempts, so if they hit the first serve out/in the net then they get another go;

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• rotating serves, so everyone gets an equal amount of serving practice;
• the receiver stands in different positions and carries their racket in different positions. The server must adjust where they place their flick serve (e.g. wide, to centre etc.).

HINTS, TIPS AND VARIATIONS

• Make your low and flick serve look the same in order to confuse your opponent and force them off-balance.

d. Forehand Low Serve

WHERE THE SHUTTLE GOES

To follow the laws of the game, the shuttle must travel from one service box to the diagonally opposite service box. Low serves travel to the front of your opponent's service box.

WHEN WE USE IT

Used mainly in women's singles to start the rally, from a defensive/neutral situation.

WHY WE USE IT

Restrict your opponent's opportunity to attack.Help create attacking opportunities for yourself.

WHAT TO COACH

PREPARE



• Sideways stance within service box.
• Basic grip.
• Racket and shuttle held high.
• Weight on rear leg.

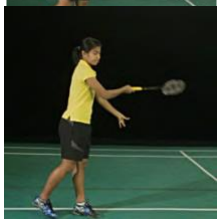
BACKSWING



• Begin transfer of weight forwards.
• Drop the shuttle to the side/in front.
• Lower the racket.
• Bend the wrist and supinate the forearm.

FORWARD SWING





• Swing racket forwards.
• Maintain bent wrist.
• Strike shuttle in front/to side.
• Push through the shuttle.

FOLLOW THROUGH

• Bring racket to ready position.

INTRODUCTORY PRACTICES FOR A FOREHAND LOW SERVE

Forehand serves are slightly more challenging than backhand serves because they involve striking a dropping shuttle. This challenge is addressed in the practices described below.

• In order to experience immediate success, encourage players to use a basic grip and place the shuttle onto the strings of the racket. The player will need to bend forwards slightly to achieve this.
• Create a short backswing by bending the wrist and supinating the forearm.
• Maintaining this cocked wrist position, the player pushes through the shuttle.

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• In small teams (e.g. 3's), each player carries a shuttle in their non-racket hand and waits behind the back line of the court.

• In turn the players run forwards to where a shuttle tube is placed on the court. From an upright standing position players aim to drop the shuttle into the tube.
• If they miss the tube they pick up the shuttle and return to the back of the queue.
• Once all shuttles are in the tube, it is emptied and the team carries on trying to improve their score. Stop the game at a set time.

Putting the previous two practices together, players aim to gradually:

- Increase the distance the shuttle is dropped;
- Increase the length of swing;

• To aid wait transfer, push the rear hip forwards followed fluently by the forward movement of the racket.

Target practices

Using the above action, push the shuttle into targets placed 4 – 6 metres away from the server. Do not use a net.

• Two players stand on opposite sides of the net.
• They place a target close to the front service line of their service box.
• The two players then have alternate forehand low serves, scoring how many times they hit the target.
• After a set time (e.g. 3 minutes) scores are compared to find a winner. If it's a draw hit the shuttle in the air and which way it points is the winner. Winners move up the hall, losers move down to take on a new opponent
.
Play a game where only forehand low serves are allowed.
Consider:

- allowing players two attempts, so if they hit the first serve out/in the net then they get another go;
- rotate serves, so everyone gets an equal amount of serving practice.

• The receiver stands in different positions and carries their racket in different positions. The server must adjust where they place their low serve (e.g. wide, to centre, at the player etc.).

HINTS, TIPS AND VARIATIONS

• Make your low, flick and high serves look the same to confuse your opponent.
• Vary where you serve to create challenges for the opponent.
• In singles, serve slightly further into the court to restrict your opponent playing tight to the net.

e. Forehand High Serve

WHERE THE SHUTTLE GOES

To follow the laws of the game, the shuttle must travel from one service box to the diagonally opposite service box. High serves travel to the rear of your opponent's service box, dropping vertically. High serves also tend to be towards the centre of the court, which restricts the angles of return that can be stuck by the receiver.

WHEN WE USE IT

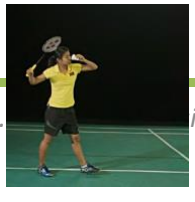
The forehand high serve is used in singles to begin the rally, from a neutral/defensive position. Forehand high serves are used in women's singles and sometimes in men's singles.

WHY WE USE IT

• As a variation (creating a different challenge to low or flick serves).
• Forces player to look up more, so they can be less aware of the servers position.

WHAT TO COACH

PREPARE



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• Adopt a sideways stance within service box.
• Basic grip.
• Racket and shuttle in elevated position.
• Weight on rear leg.

BACKSWING



• Begin transfer of weight forwards.
• Drop the shuttle to the side/in front.
• Lower the racket.
• Bend the wrist and supinate the forearm.

FORWARD SWING



• Continue weight transfer to front foot.
• Swing racket forwards.
• Accelerate racket head by pronating forearm and straightening wrist.
• Strike under shuttle – hard, in front and to side of body.

FOLLOW THROUGH



• Momentum carries racket through high and long.

HOW TO COACH - INTRODUCTORY PRACTICES - FOREHAND HIGH SERVE

In order to develop a forehand high serve, it is recommended to learn a flick serve first, then develop a longer swing and hit more underneath the shuttle.

In order to experience immediate success, encourage players to use a basic grip and place the shuttle onto the strings of the racket. The player will need to bend forwards slightly to achieve this. Create a short backswing by cocking the wrist and then, maintaining this bent wrist position, the player flicks the shuttle.

In small teams (e.g. 3's), each player carries a shuttle in their non-racket hand and waits behind the back line of the court. In turn the players run forwards to where a shuttle tube is placed on the court. From an upright standing position players aim to drop the shuttle into the tube. If they miss the tube they pick up the shuttle and return to the back of the queue. Once all shuttles are in the tube, it is emptied and the team carries on trying to improve their score. The game finishes at an agreed set time.

Putting the previous two practices together, players aim to gradually:

• increase the distance the shuttle is dropped;
• increase the length of swing. Many players will eventually start their swing with a high racket carriage;
• increase the amount of weight transfer.
• Set targets in the rearcourt.
• Make targets larger for weaker players, small for good players.

Play a game where only forehand high serves are allowed.
Consider:

- allowing players two attempts, so if they hit the first serve out/in the net then they get another go;
- alternate serves, so everyone gets an equal amount of serving practice;

• Serve must achieve a certain height, possibly judged by a "height umpire" or judging against a point on the sports hall wall. If the serve does not reach the agreed height, then the point is lost.

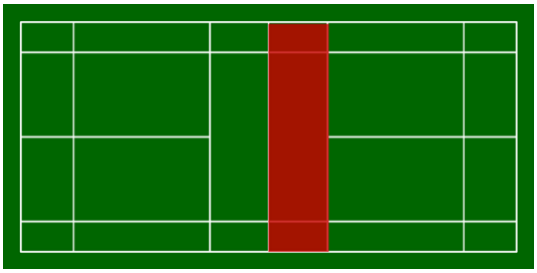
HINTS, TIPS AND VARIATIONS

• Some players do not need to carry their racket so high at the beginning, preferring to start with the racket well back, wrist bent and forearm supinated.

INTRODUCTION TO FORECOURT STROKES

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Forecourt strokes are defined as those that are played from an area between the net and the low service line. This is indicated by the red shaded area on the diagram below. A player on the right of the court will play forecourt strokes from this red area.



Forecourt strokes include:

- Backhand and forehand net lifts, which can be an attacking, defensive or neutral (rally building) option.
- Backhand and forehand net shots, which tend to be more attacking in nature.
- Backhand and forehand net kills, which are definitely an attacking option.

Of course there are times when you can play these strokes from other parts of the court (for example, lifts and net shots from the mid-court) however when starting off as a player or coach it is useful to organize the strokes under the heading of “forecourt strokes” to give a starting structure for their delivery. The sections focus on the basic straight versions of these strokes. However, cross-court versions can be developed by applying the principles outlined in the section on how to hit cross-court strokes.

a. Backhand Net Shot

WHERE THE SHUTTLE GOES

Net shots travel from forecourt to forecourt as close to top of the net as possible.

WHEN WE USE IT WHY WE USE IT

When we are in the forecourt and the shuttle has dropped below tape height (defensive/neutral area).

- To bring opponent forwards, creating possible opportunities in the rearcourt.
- Aiming to force the opponent to lift, in doing so creating an attacking opportunity.

WHAT TO COACH



PREPARE

- Basic grip.
- Hold racket out in front of body.



BACKSWING

- Establish relaxed thumb grip.
- Relaxed reach.
- Rotate arm.
- Present racket strings to shuttle.



FORWARD SWING

- Use momentum of whole body.
- Push through shuttle.

FOLLOW THROUGH



- Bring racket up ready to anticipate opponent's next stroke.

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HOW TO COACH - INTRODUCTORY PRACTICES FOR A BACKHAND NET SHOT

• Establish a thumb grip, with racket held out in front of body.
• Partner hand feeds shuttles.
• Player pushes shuttles gently into the air.
• Aims to land shuttles on a target – no net.
• Establish a thumb grip, with racket held out in front of body.
• Partner hand feeds shuttles over net.
• Player pushes shuttles gently back over net.
• Recover racket to start position.
• Player A stands in the rearcourt and hand feeds a shuttle over the net to Player B.
• Player B uses a backhand net shot , aiming to land the shuttle into the forecourt.
• Player A moves forwards to catch the shuttle, but only after the shuttle is struck.
• Player B has 10 attempts and scores one point if they force Player A to step into the forecourt, three points if they land the shuttle in the forecourt.
• To involve more players, have two feeders and two hitters who alternate.
• Players A and B have a continuous net rally, backhand to backhand.
• Players experiment with spinning the shuttles, with the emphasis being on a right to left action.
• Form two teams of 3-4 players, the teams facing each other across the net.
• Players take alternating backhand net shots, rotating towards the centre of the court after each shot.
• The shuttle is out if it lands beyond the low service line

.

HINTS, TIPS AND VARIATIONS

When closer to the net, spinning the shuttle on net shots makes it difficult for the opponent to return the shuttle. This can be achieved by hitting across the bottom of the shuttle in a slightly curved path. Shuttles spin more naturally if the racket is moved from right to left under the shuttle, although they can be made to spin the other way as well.

b. Forehand Net Shot

WHERE THE SHUTTLE GOES

Net shots travel from forecourt to forecourt as close to top of the net as possible.

WHEN WE USE IT

When we are in the forecourt and the shuttle has dropped below tape height (defensive/neutral area).

WHY WE USE IT

• To bring opponent forwards, creating possible opportunities in their rearcourt.
• Aiming to force the opponent to lift, in doing so creating an attacking opportunity.

WHAT TO COACH



PREPARE

• Basic grip.
• Hold racket out in front of body.



BACKSWING

• Relaxed reach.
• Rotate arm.
• Present racket strings to shuttle

.



FORWARD SWING

• Use momentum of whole body.
• Push through shuttle.

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FOLLOW THROUGH



• Bring racket up ready to anticipate opponent's next stroke

.

HOW TO COACH - INTRODUCTORY PRACTICES FOR A FOREHAND NET SHOT

• Establish a basic grip, with racket held out in front of body.
• Partner hand feeds shuttles.
• Player pushes shuttles gently into the air.
• Aims to land shuttles on a target – no net.
• Establish a basic grip, with racket held out in front of body.
• Partner hand feeds shuttles over net.
• Player pushes shuttles gently back over net.
• Recover racket to start position.
• A stands in the rearcourt and hand feeds a shuttle over the net to B.
• B uses a forehand net shot , aiming to land the shuttle into the forecourt.
• A moves forwards to catch the shuttle, but only after the shuttle is struck.
• B has 10 attempts and scores one point if they force A to step into the forecourt, three points if they land the shuttle in the forecourt.
• To involve more players, have two feeders and two hitters who alternate.
• Players A and B have a continuous net rally, forehand to forehand.
• Players experiment with spinning the shuttles, with the emphasis being on a right to left action.
• Form two teams of 3-4 players, the teams facing each other across the net.
• Players take alternating backhand net shots, rotating towards the centre of the court after each shot.
• The shuttle is out if it lands beyond the low service line.

HINTS, TIPS AND VARIATIONS

Spinning the shuttle on net shots makes it difficult for the opponent to return the shuttle. This can be achieved by hitting across the bottom of the shuttle in a slightly curved path. Shuttles spin more naturally if the racket is moved from right to left under the shuttle, although they can be made to spin the other way as well.

c. Backhand Net Lift

WHERE THE SHUTTLE GOES

Net lifts travel from the forecourt to the rearcourt. Attacking lifts travel just high enough to beat your opponent's racket. Defensive lifts go higher.

WHEN WE USE IT

• When you are in the forecourt and the shuttle has dropped just below tape height when you strike it (into the neutral area) – creates opportunity for attacking lift.
• When you are in the forecourt and the shuttle has dropped below well below tape height (into your defensive area) - defensive lift may be necessary.

WHY WE USE IT

• Attacking lifts aim to get the shuttle in behind your opponent to force a weaker return.
• Higher defensive lifts push your opponent back and allow more time for the player playing the stroke to recover their position and balance

WHAT TO COACH

PREPARE



• Basic grip.

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• Hold racket out in front of body.

FOREHAND SWING



• Establish thumb grip.
• Relaxed reach.
• Rotate arm inwards.
• Slight bend of elbow.

FORWARD SWING



• Reach and rotate arm outwards.
• Hit through shuttle.

FOLLOW THROUGH



• Racket momentum causes arm to rotate outwards as it relaxes.

HOW TO COACH - INTRODUCTORY PRACTICES FOR A BACKHAND NET LIFT

• Using a soft ball, hit against wall with control. Allow the ball to bounce each time and focus on the use of the thumb, forearm rotation and a flicking action.
• Progress to:

1. Volleying the ball against the wall
2. Volleying a shuttle against the wall

• Player A stands in the forecourt and hand feeds a shuttle over the net to Player B.
• Player B uses a backhand net lift , aiming to land it in the rearcourt.
• Player A can move back to catch the shuttle, but:
1. they can only back once the shuttle is struck
2. they cannot turn their back on the net.

• Player B has 10 attempts and scores one point if they force Player A to step into the rear tramlines, three points if they land the shuttle in the rear tramlines.
• To involve more players, have two feeders and two hitters who alternate.
• The game can also be expanded to include straight and cross-court lifts.
• Predictable rallies that can be used to develop backhand lifting skills include:
1. Two players - one player lifts and one player dropshots
2. Three players – dropshot, netshot, netshot, lift then repeat
3. Two players – clear, dropshot, net shot, lift then repeat

• Two players play net shots against each other.
• When ready, one player plays a backhand net lift.
• The rally is then played to a conclusion.

HINTS, TIPS AND VARIATIONS

• Cross lifts are a slightly shorter action as you are hitting the side of the shuttle. Straight lifts are a little longer so you can get underneath the shuttle.
• Very defensive, high lifts tend to have a very long action with more elbow bend.
• Make your lifts look like net shots wherever possible.

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d. Forehand Net Lift

WHERE THE SHUTTLE GOES

Net lifts travel from the forecourt to the rearcourt. Defensive lifts go higher. More attacking lifts travel just high enough to beat your opponent's racket.

WHEN WE USE IT

• When you are in the forecourt and the shuttle has dropped below well below tape height as you strike it (in your defensive area).
• When you are in the forecourt and the shuttle has dropped just below tape height when you strike it (in your neutral area).

WHY WE USE IT

• Higher defensive lifts push your opponent back and allow more time for the player playing the stroke to recover their position and balance.
• Attacking lifts aim to get the shuttle in behind your opponent to force a weaker return.

WHAT TO COACH



PREPARE

• Basic grip.
• Hold racket out in front of body.



BACKSWING

• Relaxed reach.
• Rotate arm outwards.
• Bend wrist.



FORWARD SWING

• Straighten wrist.
• Hit through the shuttle.



FOLLOW THROUGH

• Racket momentum causes arm to rotate inwards as it relaxes.

HOW TO COACH - INTRODUCTORY PRACTICES FOR A FOREHAND NET LIFT

• Using a soft ball, hit against wall with control. Allow the ball to bounce each time and focus on the use of the basic grip, wrist and forearm rotation and a flicking action. Progress to:
    1. volleying the ball against the wall.
    2. volleying a shuttle against the wall.
• Player A stands in the forecourt and hand feeds a shuttle over the net to player B.
• Player B uses a forehand net lift , aiming to land it in the rearcourt.
• Player A can move back to catch the shuttle, but:
    1. they can only back once the shuttle is struck;
    2. they cannot turn their back on the net,
• Player B has 10 attempts and scores one point if they force Player A to step into the rear tramlines, three points if they land the shuttle in the rear tramlines.
• To involve more players, have two feeders and two hitters who alternate.
• The game can also be expanded to include straight and cross-court lifts.

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• Predictable rallies that can be used to develop forehand lifting skills include:
    1. Two players- one player lifts and one player dropshots (1).
    2. Three players– dropshot, netshot, netshot, lift then repeat.
    3. Two players– clear, dropshot, net shot, lift then repeat.
• Two players play net shots against each other.
• When ready, one player plays a forehand net lift.
• The rally is then played to a conclusion.

HINTS, TIPS AND VARIATIONS

• Cross lifts are a slightly shorter action as you are hitting the side of the shuttle. Straight lifts are a little longer so you can get underneath the shuttle.
• Very defensive, high lifts tend to have a very long action, with more movement from the shoulder.
• Make your lifts look like net shots wherever possible in preparation for the stroke.

e. Backhand Net Kill

f.

WHERE THE SHUTTLE GOES

Net kills travel from the forecourt to them mid-court of your opponent in a rapid downwards direction. Kills can be directed into space or into the body of your opponent.

WHEN WE USE IT

Backhand net kills are used when you are in the forecourt and the shuttle is above tape height at the point of impact (your attacking zone).

WHY WE USE IT

Backhand net kills are used to try to win the rally, or to force your opponent to play another weak return.

WHAT TO COACH

PREPARE



• Basic grip.
• Hold racket out in front of body

.

BACKSWING



• Establish thumb grip.
• Raise and bend elbow.
• Rotate lower arm inwards.

FORWARD SWING



• Straighten arm.
• Rotate lower arm outwards.

FOLLOW THROUGH



• Racket momentum causes arm to rotate outwards as it relaxes.
• Recover racket quickly to anticipate a return.

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HOW TO COACH - INTRODUCTORY PRACTICES FOR A BACKHAND NET KILL

• Copy the coach, then shadow the stroke without the coach to copy.
• Shadow the stroke with eyes closed to get a feel for the stroke.
• Hand feed a shuttle for player to practice net kill (no net).
• Make sure feeder is in a safe position and players instructed not to strike shuttle at feeder.
• "Catcher" can be added – player catches shuttle (in a shuttle tube?). Catcher returns shuttle immediately to feeder to repeat cycle.
• Repeat the above practice but over a net (lower net for younger players).
• Vary feed so players make choices between net kill and net shot

.

HINTS, TIPS AND VARIATIONS

• Close to the net the action is very short.
• When the shuttle is close to the net you sometimes have to hit across the shuttle to avoid striking the net.
• Consider killing the shuttle into the body of the opponent, as well as straight and cross-court.

g. Forehand Net Kill

WHERE THE SHUTTLE GOES

Net kills travel from the forecourt to the midcourt of your opponent in a rapid downwards direction. Kills can be directed into space or into the body of your opponent.

WHEN WE USE IT

Forehand net kills are used when you are in the forecourt and the shuttle is above tape height at the point of impact (your attacking zone).

WHY WE USE IT

Forehand net kills are used to try to win the rally, or to force your opponent to play another weak return.

WHAT TO COACH



PREPARE

• Basic grip.
• Hold racket out in front of body



BACKSWING

• Adjust grip to panhandle.
• Bend elbow.
• Rotate upper and lower arm outwards.



FORWARD SWING

• Reach forwards by straightening elbow.
• Rotate upper and lower arm inwards.
• Hit powerfully downwards.



FOLLOW THROUGH

• As arm relaxes racket momentum causes further arm rotation inwards.
• Recover racket quickly to anticipate a return.

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HOW TO COACH - INTRODUCTORY PRACTICES FOR A FOREHAND NET KILL

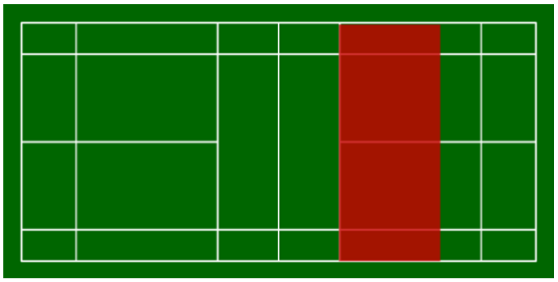
• Copy the coach, then shadow the stroke without the coach to demonstrate.
• Shadow the stroke with eyes closed to get a feel for the stroke.
• Hand feed a shuttle for player to practice net kill (no net).
• Make sure feeder is in a safe position and players instructed not to strike shuttle at feeder.
• "Catcher" can be added – player catches shuttle (in a shuttle tube?). Catcher returns shuttle immediately to feeder to repeat cycle.
• Repeat above practice but over a net (lower net for younger players).
• Vary feed so players make choices between net kill and net shot.

HINTS, TIPS AND VARIATIONS

• Close to the net the action is very short.
• When the shuttle is close to the net you sometimes have to hit across the shuttle to avoid striking the net.
• Consider killing the shuttle into the body of the opponent, as well as straight and cross-court.

. INTRODUCTION TO MIDCOURT STROKES

Midcourt strokes are defined as those that are played from the middle third of the court. This is indicated by the red shaded area on the diagram below. A player on the right of the court will play mid-court strokes from this red area



.Mid-court strokes covered here include:

• backhand and forehand drive, which can be an attacking or neutral (rally building) option;
• backhand blocks off the body, which can also be an attacking or neutral (rally building) option.

Of course there are times when you can play these strokes from other parts of the court (for example, drives from the rear-court) however when starting off as a player or coach it is useful to organize the strokes under the heading of "mid-court strokes" to give a starting structure for their delivery.

a. Block Off the Body

WHERE THE SHUTTLE GOES

Backhand blocks off the body travel from the mid-court to the forecourt/mid-court of your opponent.

WHEN WE USE IT

BH blocks are used when you are in defensive situations, returning a smash to the body. They are used mainly in doubles and less frequently in singles.

WHY WE USE IT

Backhand blocks can be used to:

• restrict the opponent's opportunity to attack.
• create an attacking opportunity by striking the block into space and forcing the opponent to hit their next shot upwards.

WHAT TO COACH



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PREPARE

• Basic grip.
• Racket held out in front of body

.
BACKSWING



• Establish relaxed thumb grip.
• Elbow forwards.
• Bend elbow.
• Open racket face (upper and lower arm rotation, bent wrist).

FORWARD SWING



• Extend elbow.
• Keep racket face open to hit slightly underneath shuttle.
• Push through shuttle.
• (In this photo player steps in on racket foot – not always possible).

FOLLOW THROUGH



• Racket momentum causes arm to rotate outwards as it relaxes.
• Re-establish basic grip and racket position in front of body.

HOW TO COACH - INTRODUCTORY PRACTICES FOR A BACKHAND BLOCK

• Copy the coach and shadow the stroke.
• Shadow the stroke without the coach.
• Shadow the stroke with eyes closed – “feel the stroke”.
• Overhead hand feed shuttle and block shuttle back to feeder.
• Block shuttles back to each other (no net).
• Player in forecourt hits down to body of player in mid-court who blocks this back.
• Repeat with four players so blocking players must block cross-court off a straight shot, straight off a cross shot.

HINTS, TIPS AND VARIATIONS

• To lift the shuttle, aim to strike underneath the shuttle and hit it harder.
• To drive the shuttle, hit flatter and harder.

Backhand Drive

WHERE THE SHUTTLE GOES

Backhand drives are flat shots that tend to travel from mid-court to mid-court or rearcourt of your opponent.

WHEN WE USE IT

Backhand drives tend to be used in neutral situations when the shuttle is neither high enough to attack downwards, nor low enough to use upwards defensive strokes.

As well as on the backhand side, backhand drives are also used when the shuttle is directly in front of the body.

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WHY WE USE IT

Backhand drives can be used to:

• restrict the opponent's opportunity to attack.
• create an attacking opportunity for the player striking the drive by hitting to space or into the body of the opponent.

WHAT TO COACH



PREPARE

• Basic grip.
• Racket out in front of body.



BACKSWING

• Retain basic grip if striking at the side of the body, adjust to thumb grip if striking in front (as in this example).
• Elbow up, forwards and bent.
• Rotate upper and lower arm inwards.



FORWARD SWING

• Straighten elbow.
• Rotate lower arm outwards.
• Hit hard through the shuttle.



FOLLOW THROUGH

• Recovery racket quickly using a rebound action and get ready for the next shot.

HOW TO COACH - INTRODUCTORY PRACTICES FOR A BACKHAND DRIVE

• Copy the coach shadowing the stroke.
• Shadow the stroke without the coach.
• Shadow the stroke with eyes closed – "feel the stroke".
• Strike a suspended shuttle with a backhand drive action.
• Strike a hand fed shuttle with a flat action no net (take care that feed is slightly to side of hitter and on non-racket side to reduce change of being struck by the shuttle).
• Players drive shuttle backwards and forwards to each other with not net.
• From the net, feeder throws down with an overhead action, immediately dropping down behind the net. Player drives shuttle back straight or cross-court.

HINTS, TIPS AND VARIATIONS

• You can play this by bringing the racket foot across the body, which might be necessary if the shuttle is very wide.
• A corner grip can be used to hit a drive when the shuttle is at the side of the player or when you wish to play the shuttle cross-court.
• Less time will mean you will not be able pronate the forearm so much – the angle between the arm and racket will be greater.
• The drive action is shorter if struck in front of the body.
• Soften the hit to block to the net.

b. Forehand Drive

WHERE THE SHUTTLE GOES

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Forehand drives are flat shots that tend to travel from mid-court to mid-court or rearcourt of your opponent.

WHEN WE USE IT

Forehand drives tend to be used in neutral situations when the shuttle is neither high enough to attack downwards, nor low enough to use upwards defensive strokes.

WHY WE USE IT

Forehand drives can be used to:

- restrict the opponent's opportunity to attack.
- create an attacking opportunity for the player striking the drive by hitting to space or into the body of the opponent.

WHAT TO COACH



PREPARE

- Basic grip.
- Racket out in front of body.



BACKSWING

- Retain basic grip if striking at the side of the body, adjust to panhandle if striking in front (as in this example).
- Raised but bent elbow.
- Rotate upper and lower arm outwards.
- Bend wrist.



FORWARD SWING

- Straighten elbow.
- Rotate upper and lower arm inwards.
- Strike in front of body (panhandle grip) or side of body (basic grip).



FOLLOW THROUGH

- Rotation of forearm will continue after impact.
- Recover racket quickly in preparation for next shot.

HOW TO COACH - INTRODUCTORY PRACTICES FOR A FOREHAND DRIVE

- Copy the coach shadowing the stroke.
- Shadow the stroke without the coach.
- Shadow the stroke with eyes closed – "feel the stroke".
- Strike a suspended shuttle using a forehand drive action.
- Strike a hand fed shuttle with a flat action with no net (take care that feed is slightly to side of hitter and on non-racket side to reduce change of being struck by the shuttle.
- Players drive shuttle backwards and forwards to each other with no net.
- From the net, feeder throws down with an overhead action, immediately dropping down behind net. Player drives shuttle back straight or cross-court.

HINTS, TIPS AND VARIATIONS

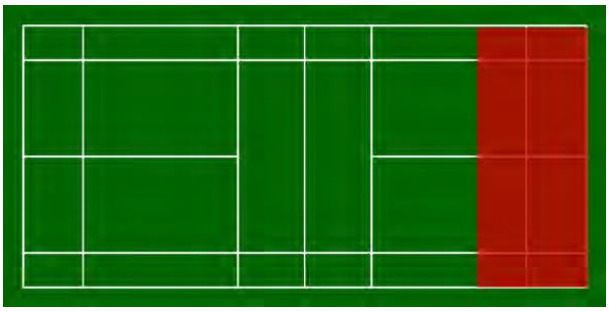
- A panhandle grip can be used to hit a drive when the shuttle is further in front of you.
- Less time will mean you will not be able pronate the forearm so much – the angle between the arm and racket will be greater.

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• Soften the hit to block to the net.

. INTRODUCTION TO REARCOURT STROKES

Rearcourt strokes are defined as those that are played from the back third of the court. This is indicated by the red shaded area on the diagram below. A player on the right of the court will play rear-court strokes from this red area.



Rear-court strokes covered here include:

• forehand clears, which can be attacking, defending or neutral (rally building);
• forehand smashes, which are attacking;
• forehand dropshots, which can be attacking, defending or neutral (rally building);
• backhand clears, which are defensive;
• forehand and backhand pulled dropshots, which are neutral (rally building).

a. Forehand Clear

WHERE THE SHUTTLE GOES

Clears go from your rearcourt to the rearcourt of your opponent.

Attacking clears travel at a height just out of reach of your opponent's racket. More defensive clears are slightly higher.

WHEN WE USE IT

Clear are used when we are in position in the rearcourt

WHY WE USE IT

.
Clears push your opponent back, creating space in the forecourt.
Attacking clears aim to place the shuttle in behind the opponent, creating pressure and potentially weaker returns.
Defensive clears allow the person playing the stroke more time to recover their balance and court position.

WHAT TO COACH

PREPARE



• Basic grip.
• Racket in overhead ready position.
• Front arm up.
• Sideways stance.

BACKSWING



• Drive up and forwards off rear leg.
• Push rear hip forwards.
• Rear shoulder and elbow move upwards and forwards.
• Upper and lower arm rotate outwards.
• Front arm pulls in to control body rotation.

FORWARD SWING

• Upper and lower arm rotates inwards.

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• Reach to strike shuttle powerfully above/slightly in front of racket shoulder.
• Rear leg overtakes front leg (after impact).



FOLLOW THROUGH

• Racket momentum causes arm to rotate inwards as it relaxes.
• Rear foot lands to become the new front foot.

HOW TO COACH - INTRODUCTORY PRACTICES FOR A FOREHAND CLEAR

• Hold the racket at the “T”.
• Hold shuttle above/slightly in front of the racket shoulder.
• Place the racket handle at the side of the shuttle.
• Using forearm rotation, strike the shuttle out of the hand.
• Suspend a shuttle at a relaxed hitting height.
• Hold the racket using a basic grip.
• Reach up and place racket face on the shuttle.
• Rotate forearm to point bottom of grip to shuttle.
• Create angle between forearm and racket.
• Reverse rotation and strike the shuttle.
• Suspend a shuttle at a relaxed hitting height.
• Hold the racket using a basic grip.
• Adopt a sideway stance and a relaxed ready position.
• Push rear hip forwards, commit elbow up and forwards and use forearm rotation to point bottom of grip to shuttle. Create an angle between racket and forearm.
• Reverse rotation, reach and strike the shuttle.
• Suspend a shuttle at a relaxed hitting height.
• Hold the racket using a basic grip.
• Form a relaxed ready position and step back to load rear leg.
• Push aggressively upwards and forwards off rear leg.
• Jump and throw racket head at the shuttle.
• Kick through and land back foot – front foot in quick succession.
• Repeat any of the above using a hand fed shuttle.

HINTS, TIPS AND VARIATIONS
• “Holding” the stroke slightly between the backswing and forwards swing can help deceive your opponent as it affects their movement.

b. Forehand Smash

WHERE THE SHUTTLE GOES.

Smashes go from your rear court to the midcourt of your opponent.Smashes can be struck into space, or into the body of the opponent.

WHEN WE USE IT.

We use smashes when hitting down from our attacking zone

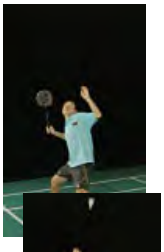
. WHY WE USE IT.

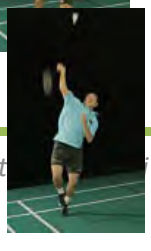
A forehand smash is a shot used in an attempt to win the rally, or to force a very weak return.

WHAT TO COACH

PREPARE

• V-Grip.
• Relaxed ready position.
• Step back to load rear leg, sideways stance.





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BACKSWING

• Jump and begin rotating in the air, elbow upforwards,supinate forearm ("brush your hair").
• Create angle between arm and racket.



FORWARD SWING

• Continue rotation in the air, throw racket head powerfully (pronate forearm).
• Reach up to strike shuttle. impact in front of striking shoulder.



FOLLOW THROUGH `
• Finish rotation and land.
• Relaxation allows continued forearm rotation.
• Racket stays in front of body.

HOW TO COACH - INTRODUCTORY PRACTICES FOR A FOREHAND SMASH

• The basic practices for forehand overhead hitting actions will all be of benefit to a player performing a forehand overhead smash.
• Suspend a shuttle at a relaxed hitting height.
• Hold the racket using a basic grip.
• Form a relaxed ready shape and step back to load rear leg.
• Push aggressively upwards and forwards off rear leg.
• Jump and throw racket head at the shuttle.
• Strike the shuttle in front of you and visualise hitting the shuttle down.
• Kick through and land back foot – front foot in quick succession.
• Hold the racket using a basic grip.
• Form a relaxed ready position and step back to load rear leg.
• Using an underarm action, a feeder places a shuttle high in the air.
• Push aggressively upwards and forwards off rear leg.
• Jump and throw racket head at the shuttle.
• Strike the shuttle in front of you and hit the shuttle down.
• Use a racket feed and repeat the above practice.
• Add in targets to encourage steeper and more accurate hits.
• Smash – block – block – lift.
• Play a game of singles or doubles. If the rally is won with a smash, or the shot after a smash, then three points are scored rather than one.

HINTS, TIPS AND VARIATIONS

• Vary the pace of smashes to deceive your opponent and make them mistime their returns.
• Smash into space or as an alternative, into the body.

c. Forehand Dropshot

WHERE THE SHUTTLE GOES

Dropshots go from your rearcourt to the forecourt of your opponent. Longer drops tend to land just beyond the low service line. Shorter dropshots land between the low service line and the net.

WHEN WE USE IT

Dropshots are used when we are in the attacking rear court zone.

WHY WE USE IT

We use dropshots to:

• make space in the rearcourt.
• make our opponent off-balance.

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• encourage out opponent to lift.

WHAT TO COACH



PREPARE

• Basic grip.
• Racket in overhead ready position.
• Bring front arm up.
• Establish sideways stance.



BACKSWING

• Drive up and forwards off rear leg.
• Push rear hip forwards.
• Rear shoulder/elbow move.
• Upper and lower arm rotate outwards.



FORWARD SWING

• Upper and lower arm rotates inwards.
• Reach to strike shuttle above/ slightly in front of striking shoulder.
• Just prior to hitting rotation of arm stops -push through the shuttle.



FOLLOW THROUGH

• Rear foot lands to become the new front foot.

HOW TO COACH - INTRODUCTORY PRACTICES FOR A FOREHAND DROPSHOT

The basic practices for forehand overhead hitting actions will all be of benefit to a player performing a forehand dropshot.
• Suspend a shuttle at a relaxed hitting height.
• Hold the racket using a basic grip.
• Form a relaxed overhead ready position and step back to load rear leg.
• Push aggressively upwards and forwards off rear leg.
• Jump and throw, then slow the racket head just before striking the shuttle.
• Hold the racket using a basic grip.
• Form a relaxed overhead ready position and step back to load rear leg.
• Using an underarm action, a feeder places a shuttle high in the air.
• Push aggressively upwards and forwards off rear leg.
• Jump and throw, then slow the racket head just before striking the shuttle.
• Use a racket feed and repeat the above practice.
• Add in targets to encourage steeper and more accurate hits.
• Dropshot – lift – dropshot – lift.
• Play a game of singles or doubles. If the rally is won with a dropshot, or the shot after a dropshot, then three points are scored rather than one.
HINTS, TIPS AND VARIATIONS

• The above example shows a deceptive dropshot, where being aggressive with your body and speed of racket head in the first stages of the stroke puts your opponent off-balance by making them think it is a clear or smash.
• Experiment with slicing the shuttle both right to left and left to right to increase the range and deception of your overhead strokes.

d. Pulled Forehand Dropshot

WHERE THE SHUTTLE GOES WHEN WE USE IT WHY WE USE IT

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Pulled forehand dropshots go from your rearcourt to the front of your opponent's midcourt, with the shuttle being drawn towards (but not into) the middle of the court.

Pulled forehand dropshots tend to be used in defensive situations, when the shuttle is behind you in the forehand corner.

Pulled forehand dropshots are used to relieve pressure by restricting your opponent's ability to attack the shuttle by:

- Making it more difficult to play tight to the net
- Restricting the angle of return of your opponents

WHAT TO COACH



PREPARE

- Carry racket with racket head above hand.
- Bent elbow.
- Turn racket in hand towards a thumb grip (more turn if you want to hit cross-court).



BACKSWING

- Rotate upper and lower arm outwards.
- Maintain bent elbow.



FORWARD SWING

- Straighten arm (relaxed reach).
- Rotate lower upper and lower arm inwards.
- Aim to get racket hand underneath shuttle.
- Just prior to striking, reduce arm rotation and push through shuttle.
- Impact slightly behind player.

FOLLOW THROUGH



- Complete pushing through shuttle.
- Use follow through to help you turn quickly to face the net.

HOW TO COACH - INTRODUCTORY PRACTICES FOR A FOREHAND PULLED DROPSHOT

- Copy the coach shadowing the stroke.
- Shadow the stroke without the coach.
- Shadow the stroke with eyes closed – "feel the stroke".
- Stand sideways on to a net or a wall.
- Shadow the stroke.
- Use the net/wall to help keep the racket head below the hand on the forward pull.
- Suspend a shuttle.
- Stand with the shuttle slightly behind and to the side of you.
- Step towards the shuttle then strike it.
- Recover to starting position.
- Racket feed single shuttle over net.
- Turn and step into stroke.
- Strike shuttle.
- Turn back to face net.
- Feed new shuttle.

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HINTS, TIPS AND VARIATIONS

• Experiment with changing your grip to change the racket face so you can play both straight and cross court.

e. Backhand Clear

WHERE THE SHUTTLE GOES

Backhand clears go from your rearcourt to the rearcourt of your opponent.

WHEN WE USE IT WHY WE USE IT

A backhand clear is used when the player is in a neutral or defensive situation.

WHEN WE USE IT WHY WE USE IT

Backhand clears are used to create time for the striking player to turn and re-establish a balanced position on the court.



WHAT TO COACH

PREPARE

• Basic grip or corner grip (turn to panhandle if deeper).
• Approach with elbow down, racket head up.



BACKSWING

• Maintain bent elbow.
• Start to raise elbow and drop the racket head (upper/low arm rotates inwards).
• Make sure backswing flows immediately into forward swing.



FORWARD SWING

• Straighten arm (relaxed reach). Rotate upper/lower arm outwards.
• Impact at side/slightly behind player, with hand below the shuttle.
• "Punch" the shuttle, hitting hard but stopping hand immediately on impact.



FOLLOW THROUGH

• Hand stops but racket head continues as racket bends.
• As hand relaxes racket rebounds backwards.

HOW TO COACH - INTRODUCTORY PRACTICES FOR A BACKHAND CLEAR

• Copy the coach shadowing the stroke.
• Shadow the stroke without the coach.
• Shadow the stroke with eyes closed – “feel the stroke”.
• Suspend a shuttle.
• Stand with back to net, shuttle slightly behind you.
• Strike the shuttle.
• Turn back to face the net.
• Stand with back to wall.
• Begin backswing.
• Strike a hand-fed shuttle into the wall.
• Turn back to face the wall.
• Racket feed single shuttle over net.

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• Turn back to net.
• Strike shuttle.
• Turn back to face net.

HINTS, TIPS AND VARIATIONS

• Experiment with changing your grip and bending the wrist, in doing so changing the racket face so you can play both straight and cross court clears.
• This can be changed in a backhand smash by bending the wrist more on the forward swing to bring the shuttle down more.

f. Backhand Pulled Dropshot

WHERE THE SHUTTLE GOES

Backhand dropshots trave from the rearcourt to the front of the midcourt (just beyond the low service line).

Pulled backhand dropshots tend to be used in defensive situations, when the shuttle is behind you in the backhand corner.

Pulled backhand dropshots are used to relieve pressure, restricting your opponent's ability to attack the shuttle by:

• Making it more difficult to play tight to the net.
• Restricting the angle of return of your opponents.



WHAT TO COACH - Backhand Pulled Dropshot

PREPARE

• Corner grip (panhandle if deeper).
• Approach with elbow down, racket head up.



BACKSWING

• Maintain bent elbow.
• Start to raise elbow and drop the racket head (upper/low arm rotates inwards).
• Make sure backswing flows immediately into forward swing (this position is not held).



FORWARD SWING

• Straighten arm (relaxed reach).
• Rotate upper/lower arm outwards.
• Just prior to striking, reduce arm rotation and push through shuttle.
• Impact slightly behind player, with hand below the shuttle.



FOLLOW THROUGH

• Complete pushing through shuttle and use racket momentum to help you turn quickly into court.

HOW TO COACH - INTRODUCTORY PRACTICES FOR A BACKHAND PULLED DROPSHOT

• Copy the coach shadowing the stroke.
• Shadow the stroke without the coach.
• Shadow the stroke with eyes closed – "feel the stroke".
• Stand sideways on to a net or a wall.
• Shadow the stroke.
• Use the net/wall to help keep the racket head below the hand or the forward pull.
• Suspend a shuttle.
• Stand with back to net, shuttle behind you.

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• Step towards the shuttle then strike it.
• Turn back to face the net.
• Racket feed single shuttle over net.
• Turn back to net.
• Strike shuttle.
• Turn back to face net.
• Feed new shuttle.

HINTS, TIPS AND VARIATIONS

• The deeper the shuttle, or the more you wish to hit cross-court, the more you turn the grip to a panhandle position.
• Plant the leading foot (right foot for a right hander) with or slightly before impact, allowing you to turn out of the stroke quickly.

SUMMARY – PERFORMANCE FACTOR 1: TECHNICAL

(HITTING SKILLS)

The areas covered in the hitting skills section are:

• the basic biomechanical principles that underpin effective hitting;
• practices to develop catching and throwing;
• the different types of grip used in badminton and describe practices to develop them;
• the different badminton strokes, including:

- where you play them;
- when you play them;
- why you play them;
- what they look like;
- how to practice them;

Since variety and deception are very important tactical tools for a badminton player, encourage experimentation, especially slicing the shuttle overhead and spinning the shuttle at the net. Basic methods to introduce these skills have been suggested, but these will be developed in more detail in the BWF Level 2 Coach Course.

The most closely related parts of the manual are:

• movement and body skills;
• devising progressive practices.

Below is a short series of multiple choice questions where you can check what you have remembered from the hitting skills section.__

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MODULE 6
PERFORMANCE FACTOR 2 TACTICS

01. BADMINTON DEFINED

Badminton is:

• a net game;
• played on a rectangular court;
• a volleying game, with rallies beginning with an underarm serve.The aim of the game is to score points by:
• landing the shuttlecock in your opponent's court
• forcing your opponent to hit the shuttlecock out of the court
• forcing your opponent to hit the shuttlecock into the net
• striking your opponent's body with the shuttle

02. BADMINTON "SITUATIONS"

To perform well at badminton, players have to cope with three broad types of situation, which can be labelled:

• attacking
• neutral
• defensive

These situations are related to how high the shuttle is when it is being struck and how close the shuttle is to the net. These situations are represented in the illustration below.
To be successful at badminton, players will have to make decisions about the type of stoke being played and this will largely be decided by the situation they are in: defensive, neutral and attacking

03. IMPORTANCE OF 'EARLY' TO BADMINTON PERFORMANCE

Striking the shuttle 'early', in terms of both height and closeness to the net, means the player will:

• find themselves in attacking situations more often, with a greater number of opportunities to strike the shuttle downwards into their opponent's court;
• be able to exert more pressure on their opponents by giving them less time;
• have more options as to the type of strokes that can be played.

Defensive
Neutral situations
Attacking
Early
Net

03. TACTICS DEFINED

Tactics can be defined as:

"The capacity to make effective decisions based on awareness of the situation."

From this definition we can see that tactics consists of two linked components: Tactical Awareness is mainly about being able to 'read' each situation on the court, whereas decision making is reacting to the information that you have read. The two components that make up tactics are further expanded in the table below.

TACTICAL AWARENESS (READ)

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SPACE
• Using width effectively.
• Using depth effectively.
• Using height effectively.

SELF
• My personal strengths.
• My personal weaknesses.
• Awareness of position on court.
• Awareness of state of balance.

OPPONENT
• What they are good at.
• What they are not good at.
• What they are trying to do against me.

PACE
• Is the pace I am hitting at helping me to win?

PARTNER
• What are their strengths?
• What are their weaknesses?
• Where are they on the court?

DECISION-MAKING (REACT)
• Decisions made prior to matches, for example deciding on a game plan.
• Decisions made between rallies, for example a change of tactic based the outcome of previous rallies.
• Decisions made between strokes in a rally, for example where to move to in order to anticipate your opponent's return shot.

04. RELATED COACHING SKILLS

There are two coaching skills that can be very effective when developing the tactical skills of players.

PROBLEM-SOLVING EXERCISES

Since tactics involves players responding to the challenges presented by their opponent, it makes sense that players developing problem-solving skills will help them to progress their tactical skills.Practices that help the players to work out the answers for themselves, rather than the coach telling the players the answers, are highly effective.

05. QUESTIONING SKILLS

Always telling players the answers to challenges actually reduces their ability to develop tactically, as it means the coach is solving problems for them. Effective questioning therefore is a great coaching tool that helps players to develop problem-solving skills as it encourages them to come up with their own answers.

06. BASE POSITION

The 'base position' can be defined as:

"The court position from which you are best able to deal with your opponent's probable replies."

Other keys facts about the base position include:
• the base is a fluid position, not a set point on the court;
• the base position is where the player will perform a split step, timed with your opponent striking the shuttle.





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08. SINGLES TACTICS

Men's and women singles share some of the basic tactical approaches, such as use of space, playing to your strengths, exploiting your opponent's weaknesses etc. Men's singles generally is more attacking, which is generally a reflection on their additional speed and power. This means there is less clearing in men's singles (with more hitting down) and low serves are used much more. Women's singles requires a slightly more patient approach to creating attacking opportunities.

WHAT TO COACH:

Singles High Serve

• The singles high serve is used mainly in women's singles. It forces your opponent to the back, restricting the effectiveness of any attack, and gives the server time to react to the next shot.
• High serves are used less in men's singles, especially at the top level, as they can attack this serve more explosively.



The high serve is usually directed towards the centre of the court, allowing the server to cover the angles of return more effectively.



After serving high, take up a position slightly to the same side you have served to. This helps you cover the straight returns, which are not in the air as long as cross-court returns.

HOW TO COACH: Singles High Serve

HOW TO COACH
• Mark target areas in the rearcourt that encourage players to hit both deep and to the centre. Make the target deeper and smaller for more competent players. This can be turned into a competition if alternating serves are used.
• Play a game where only high serves are allowed. Use alternating serves so each player gets an equal amount of serving practice.
• Mark targets on the court (e.g. using tape) encouraging players to serve centrally and deep. Play a game where only high serves are allowed. Use alternating serves so each player gets an equal amount of serving practice. If the serve is left and lands outside the target, the point is lost.

WHAT TO COACH: Return of High Serve

When receiving a good length high serve in women's singles, flatter attacking clears, as played by the far side player in this photo, can be used to exert pressure and make your opponent off balance. Straight clears are easier to follow up than cross-court clears. Clears also give the receiver more time to respond to the next stroke.

If the high serve is short, smashes can be used effectively. Straight smashes are easier to follow up than cross-court. Dropshots can also be used to attack a short high serve. Cross-court dropshots are a useful contrast to the straight smash, but be aware that a greater distance is required to follow-up.

HOW TO COACH: Return of High Serve

• Play a game of singles where one player serves ten times and then the other player serves 10 times. Rallies are played as usual but two points are awarded if a rally is won when a particular stroke (e.g. straight clear) is used to return serve. This can be used to raise awareness of using particular returns of serve effectively.

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• Players work in a group of three, with one player stands outside the court. The remaining two players play singles normally to five points, but if a player wins the rally with a smash return of serve, or their next shot, they win the match. The player who is off court will therefore have their turn if:

- One player reaches five points – the loser of the game will be replaced;
- One player wins a rally with a smash return of serve or their next shot.

• Players are restricted to using only two possible returns of serve (e.g. a straight clear and a cross-court dropshot). Players otherwise play as normal. At the end of the game the coach facilitates a discussion with each player as to the effectiveness of those returns against that particular opponent.

WHAT TO COACH: Singles Low Serves

Low serves, especially backhand low serves, are used a great deal in men's singles. Forehand low serves are used more as a variation in women's singles. Low serves can force the opponent to lift the shuttle.

Low singles serves are usually delivered to the centre of the court to reduce the receiver's angles of return.



As a variation low serves can be directed more towards the receiver. This can disrupt their preferred return of serve.



HOW TO COACH: Singles Low Serves

• Set targets on both sides of the net, near the front of the service box and towards the centre of the court. Players have alternate serves, with the winner being the player that hits the target the most times in three minutes. This can be adapted so winners then challenge other winners in the hall for a further three minutes.
• Play a singles game where only low serves are allowed. Receivers should start the rally from their normal receiving position and not break the rules by moving before the serve is delivered. Players can alternate serves as a way to make sure each player gets an equal amount of practice. Some variation, serving to the centre and at the player, should be encouraged.

WHAT TO COACH: Return of Low Singles Serve

Net shots can be effective in forcing a lift which you can attack. Consider:
● taking it early;
● making it look like a lift;
● spinning the shuttle;
● using the centre to cover the angles of return.

Lifts have a better margin for error than net shots. Aim to put your opponent under pressure by placing the shuttle behind them and into the rearcourt corners. To do this:
● take the shuttle early;
● make it look like a net shot;
● use just enough height to be out of reach of your opponent;
● aim for the rearcourt corners.

HOW TO COACH: Return of Low Singles Serve

• Place a marker halfway down the net in the centre of the court. A singles game is then played where only low serves are allowed. An umpire watching the match calls "fault" if any return of serve is struck below the marker on the net. This encourages the receiver to take the shuttle early when receiving a low singles serve.
• Play a normal game but award a bonus point if a rally is won when a particular return of serve is used.

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WHAT TO COACH: Singles Flick Serve

Flick serves are used in singles as a variation, in particular as a surprise after a period of low serving.

the aim of the flick serve is to make the receiver off-balance when they play their return.



Flick serves are often served wide in order to try to force a predictable straight return.



HOW TO COACH: Singles Flick Serve

Play a singles game where only low and flick serves are allowed, with a bonus point being awarded if a rally is won when a flick serve was used at the start of a rally.

WHAT TO COACH: Return of Singles Flick Serve

If off balance and hitting down, focus on a good downward angle and accuracy. Reducing the power will help this and also give the receiver more time to recover ready for the next shot.

Straight clears can be used as a return to a wide flick serve, but focus on hitting a good depth. Clears give you more time to recover your position.

Take care using cross-court replies off a flick serve, especially if off-balance, as they are difficult to follow up.

HOW TO COACH: Return of Singles Flick Serve

HOW TO COACH EXAMPLES
- Start a rally with a flick serve, a controlled downward straight shot and a cross-block. Then play the rally out.
- Start with a flick serve, straight clear then play the rally out.
- Play a game where the players alternate their flick serves. Award bonus points for a rally won with a particular return (e.g. straight smash). Receivers should start from their normal position and not move until the serve is delivered. Receivers could be asked to start slightly further forwards.

WHAT TO COACH: Singles Neutral Play (1)

In singles play there are parts of rallies where neither player is clearly on the attack. During these periods of neutral play both players should aim to move their opponent around the court in order exploit any space they create. Patience is an important part during neutral phases of play.



Straight shots on the whole allow you to stay more in control because they involve recovering to a base

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that is closer from where you have hit your last stroke. Of course this does not mean you should not use cross-court strokes, but you should be confident you can position yourself to deal with your opponent's reply when using them.



During neutral play use the corners of the court to move your opponent around.



HOW TO COACH: Singles Neutral Play (1)

HOW TO COACH EXAMPLES

• Play rallies where players are encouraged to use a high percentage of straight shots, followed by a period of normal play. The coach then leads a discussion on the possible advantages and disadvantages of straight and cross-court strokes.

• Two players compete at singles with each player being observed by a partner. The observer records how many strokes intended to reach the rearcourt (lifts and clears) would have reached the back tramlines if left. After one game players given the feedback (e.g. 8 out of 15 clears would have landed in the back tramlines). The players play again and try to improve their statistics.

• Play a game where the corners of the court are marked. Competitive games are played where strokes that land outside these corners are classed as outcoach leads a discussion on the use of this exercise and any situations where use of the corners may not be so appropriate (see next section).

WHAT TO COACH: Singles Neutral Play (2)

Against players who do not recover well after each stroke, consider making them travel long diagonals across the court. Beware however that this tactic:

● involves you hitting cross court, so you should be sure that you can cover the reply;

● may not be good against an opponent with good straight line speed.



Getting the player to change direction can be a useful tactic to make a player off-balance. This can involve a player:

● turning through 90 degrees (shown above);
● returning to the same corner.



Sometimes playing tight across the net, but slightly more into court, can be useful as it removes the opportunity for the opponent to play tight, spinning net shots. Consider on occasions playing to the centre of the net so you can cover the angles of return equally.



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HOW TO COACH: Singles Neutral Play (2)
HOW TO COACH EXAMPLES

• Let two players play singles. Instruct one player to use a tactic of making their opponent cover long diagonals as much as possible. The other player should be asked to guess the tactic being used and combat it accordingly. At the end of the game players discuss the tactic and its relative effectiveness against different types of opponent.

• Let two players play singles. Instruct one player to use a tactic of making their opponent return to the same corner as much as possible. The other player should be asked to guess the tactic being used and combat it accordingly. At the end of the game players discuss the tactic and its relative effectiveness against different types of opponent.

• Play a game of singles where the forecourt area (from the net to the low service line) is out. Place two markers about 3 meters apart in the centre of the net. Players must play all net shots through this “gate”. At the end of the game players discuss playing off the net and using the centre of the net.

WHAT TO COACH: Singles Attack



Moving a player away from an area of weakness, then attacking that area can be a useful tactic. In the above example the nearside player hits to other corners, eventually exploiting the forehand forecourt of their opponent.



Once an attacking opportunity has been established, then there is often an increase in pace.

In the above example the far side player responds to a short lift with fast movement backwards and Hard-hitting, downward shots.



The more under pressure your opponent, the further forwards you should make your base. In the above example the nearside player has played a tight, early net shot which pressurizes their opponent, so they stay further forwards.

A lift from the far side player would have to be very high and would lack depth. This allows the nearside player to stay forwards and look for the opportunity to net kill.

HOW TO COACH: Singles Attack
HOW TO COACH EXAMPLES

Play a game where you get a bonus point if you win a point with a stroke to a particular corner of the court or with the next stroke after playing to that corner.

WHAT TO COACH: Rearcourt Singles Defence



When the shuttle is behind you in the rearcourt, a good length clear can bring you back into the rally. Cross-court clears can also be used, but this is riskier as it is more difficult to hit a good length and it is harder to cover the next shot.



When the shuttle is behind you in the rearcourt, a pulled dropshot can bring you back into the rally. This has the advantage of restricting your opponent's ability to attack. The dropshot should be placed a little deeper in court to restrict the opponent's ability to play tight to the net. Backhand pulled dropshots can also be used in the same way.

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Cross court dropshots can also be used as a variation, but these are harder to follow up.

HOW TO COACH: Rearcourt Singles Defence

HOW TO COACH EXAMPLES

Player ‘A’ strikes the shuttle from the one corner near the net to player ‘B’ who is in the mid-court, slightly cross-court to player ‘B’. This continues until player ‘A’ decides to play a straight flat lift into the rearcourt. Player ‘B’ then replies with a clear or pulled dropshot and the play the rally out. This practice can be developed by designing different starts to the rally – anything can be used which results in one player having to play stroke from slightly behind you in the rearcourt.

WHAT TO COACH: Midcourt Singles Defence



A cross-court block off a straight smash means the follow-up is more difficult for the player using the smash.



A straight block off a cross-court smash means the follow-up is more difficult for the player using the smash.

HOW TO COACH: Midcourt Singles Defence
HOW TO COACH EXAMPLES

• Two players start a rally and create a situation where player ‘A’ has the opportunity to play a straight smash. Player ‘B’ should respond mainly to a straight smash with a cross-court block, although they can occasionally play other types of return. Players then play the rally out.
• Two players start a rally and create a situation where player ‘A’ has the opportunity to play a cross-court smash. Player ‘B’ should respond mainly to a crosscourt smash with a straight block, although they can occasionally play other types of return. Players then play the rally out.

WHAT TO COACH: Forecourt Singles Defence



In the forecourt lifts should be of good depth, with sufficient height to clear the opponent's racket and allow enough time for the lifting player to recover their position. Straight lifts are easier to recover from than cross-court lifts as the base required to cover the next shot is closer.

HOW TO COACH: Forecourt Single Defence
HOW TO COACH EXAMPLES

Play a game of singles where only straight lifts are allowed. After one set change so that both straight and cross-lifts are allowed. Then discuss the use of these strokes in singles.

07. DOUBLES TACTICS

INTRODUCTION

Men’s and women's doubles share many of the same characteristics. In particular, both use front and back as their attacking formation and side by side as their defensive formation. Men’s doubles does however tend to be more explosive and clearing the shuttle is relatively rare. The ability to serve and return effectively is crucial in men’s doubles. Women’s doubles is less explosive and relies more on patient rally building to break down opponent's defences. The longest rallies in badminton tend to occur in ladies doubles.

WHAT TO COACH: Low Serving in Women’s



Doubles (1)

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In women's doubles, the server delivers from close to the "T" on the court, with their partner stood centrally in the mid-court.

Low serves are generally delivered to the centre to cut down the possible angles of return.





• For variation, low serves can also be directed towards the receiver. This can disrupt their preferred way of returning serve.
• Occasionally you may serve wide into the tramlines, but this is a higher risk strategy as it makes the serving pair open to a straight return into space.

HOW TO COACH: Low Serving in Women's Doubles (1)
HOW TO COACH EXAMPLES
Play women's doubles games where only low serves are allowed. Service receivers should:

• receive from their normal position;
• obey the rules by not moving before the serve is struck;
• be sensible about returns (e.g. not hitting hard at the head of the server);
• adjust their receiving position (i.e. slightly wider, slightly more central);
• carry their racket in different positions (wider on forehand, in front of body, wider on backhand).

Servers should vary where they serve to in response to the different positions and racket carriage of the receiver.

WHAT TO COACH: Low Serving in Women's Doubles (2)

Following the low serve, the server should look to cover any net replies.





The server should also look to anticipate pushed replies to the mid- and rearcourt. This usually involves chooses one side to cover.

The server's partner is responsible for covering returns to mid- and rearcourt.



HOW TO COACH: Low Serving in Women's Doubles (2)
HOW TO COACH EXAMPLES

Play women's doubles games where only low serves are allowed. Service receivers should:

• receive from their normal position;
• obey the rules by not moving before the serve is struck;

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• be sensible about returns (e.g. not hitting hard at the head of the server).

The game is scored as normal, apart from the serving team being able to score two points if they win a rally with the 3rd shot of the rally.

WHAT TO COACH: Receiving Low serves
Women's Doubles (1)

If the receiver plays a net reply to the serve, they should seek to dominate the net and kill any further net shots from the server.



Straight returns of serve to the mid-court should be followed by an attempt to intercept any straight replies.



Similarly, on playing a straight return to the rearcourt, the receiver should look to intercept any straight replies



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HOW TO COACH: Receiving Low serves
Women's Doubles (1)
HOW TO COACH EXAMPLES

Play women's doubles games where only low serves are allowed. Service receivers should:

• receive from their normal position;
• obey the rules by not moving before the serve is struck;
• be sensible about returns (e.g. not hitting hard at the head of the server).

The game is scored as normal, apart from the receiving team being able to score two points if they win a rally with the 4th shot of the rally.

WHAT TO COACH: Receiving Low Serves
Women's Doubles (2)

The receiver may choose to attack into the body of the server's partner, in which case they should prepare to cover both sides for a possible reply.



If the receiver plays an inaccurate return, they may have to retreat off the net and form a side by side formation.



HOW TO COACH: Receiving low serves in women's doubles (2)
HOW TO COACH EXAMPLES

• Play a women's doubles game where only low serves are allowed. Service receivers should:

  - receive from their normal position;

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- obey the rules by not moving before the serve is struck;
- be sensible about returns (e.g. not hitting hard at the head of the server).

The game is scored as normal, apart from the receiving team being able to score two points if they win a rally with the 4th shot of the rally.

• Play women's doubles but no rally is allowed to go on longer than five shots. After five shots the rally is stopped and the point awarded to the doubles team on the attack/in control of the rally. Some lets may occur.

WHAT TO COACH: Women's Doubles Flick Serve



Flick serves can be used as a useful variation, pushing the receiver back and often forcing them to hit the shuttle when off-balance. Wide serves are often more difficult to deal with, especially out to the forehand side.



Wide flick serves often draw a predictable straight reply, which can be anticipated by the server's partner.



Following a wide flick serve that has clearly deceived the receiver, the server may find they are able to stay closer to the net as a full length crosscourt clear is unlikely.

HOW TO COACH: Women's doubles flick serve
HOW TO COACH EXAMPLES

Play a game with a higher than normal percentage of flick serves. Bonus points awarded to the serving team when they win rallies with a flick serve.

WHAT TO COACH: Women's doubles flick serve return



If flicked wide and on-balance, smash at the straight player or between the two players. A dropshot placed between the two players is also a useful variation.



If flicked to the centre and on-balance, smash at the retreating server or between the two players. A dropshot placed between the two players is once again an option.

When returning a flick that has put the receiver off balance



consider using a half smash, dropshot or straight clear, all of which give more time for the receiver to regain their balance.

HOW TO COACH: Women's Doubles Flick Serve Return
HOW TO COACH EXAMPLES

Play a game with a higher than normal percentage of flick serves. Bonus points awarded to the either team if they win a rally that began with a flick serve.



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WHAT TO COACH: Women's doubles Rallying – rearcourt attack

When attacking in women's doubles the main responsibility of the rear player is to:

- cover the mid and rearcourt;
- be patient, waiting for good attacking opportunities;
- set up attacking opportunities for the front player.

The rear player uses:

- steep dropshots to pressurise their opponents;
- shots to the middle of the two players to cut down the angles of return (shown above);
- smashes, most often at the straight player or to the middle of the two players, to force a weak return or hit a winner;
- cross-court drops and smashes as a variation;
- clears for variation.



Players will rotate positions if:

- there is a good opportunity to follow their own attack positively and
- the front player has read the situation and commits more centrally to cover other areas of the court.



HOW TO COACH: Women's doubles Rallying – rearcourt attack
HOW TO COACH EXAMPLES

- One player works hard in the rearcourt, playing dropshots between to players in a side by side formation. The two players lift to move the rearcourt player across the back line.
- Work in doubles formations, one pair front and back (attacking) and the other side by side (defending). The defending pair moves the rearcourt player round. This player responds with dropshots between the two defending players. One defending player then lifts deliberately shorter and wide, giving the opportunity for the rearcourt player to:
    - smash;
    - follow in to the net.

The forecourt player moves across to allow the rearcourt player to follow up their smash. Players then play the rally out.

- Bonus points for rearcourt strokes that are winners, force an error or create a winner for the front player on the next shot.
- Place two markers on the net so the net is split into thirds. Place a further one marker in the centre of the net. (-------●--------●--------●---------). Play a normal game of doubles but dropshots from the left rearcourt must go through the ●---------● "gate", dropshots from right should go through the ●---------● "gate".

WHAT TO COACH: Front player attack (1)
When attacking at women's doubles the main responsibility of the front player is to:



- cover the mid- and forecourt;
- take the shuttle early;
- intercept drives and pushes;
- hit winners;
- maintain the attack.

When lifted to the rearcourt, the front player should take up a midcourt position on the same side of the court as the shuttle. This "channel attack" position is most effective when the attack is directed at the straight player or to the middle, as it can create a 2 vs 1 situation.



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HOW TO COACH: Front player attack (1)
HOW TO COACH EXAMPLES

• Players are given a number or letter (1 and 2 on one side of the net, A and B on the other side of the net). These players all begin in side by side positions. No shuttles are involved in this practice. The coach calls out a number, then a letter, then a number, then a letter (e.g. 1, A, 1, B, 2, B etc.). When the number or letter is called out, that player moves to one side in the rearcourt and their partner takes up a front “channel attack” position. The opposing pair should automatically form a side by side position.

• four players on the court, two on each side in side by side positions. One player “serves” a shuttle high (i.e. a straight lift) one side and the receiving pair move automatically in to a “channel attack” position. The rally is then played to a conclusion.

• Players can be encouraged to design short openings to rallies that help players form “side by side” and “channel attack” positions, then the players play the rally out.

WHAT TO COACH: Front player attack (2)



When there partner is using dropshots, the front player should move in to the net to threaten and prevent any attempted net replies. The front player will know a dropshot has been played by the movement of the opposition.



When the rear player has an opportunity to follow their own attack into the midcourt and forecourt, the front player can show they are ready for this by moving more to the centre line of the court, or even into the other half court. This allows them to cover the area of the court left by the advancing rearcourt player (team on the left).

HOW TO COACH: Front player attack (2)
HOW TO COACH EXAMPLES

• Two players form a front and back (attacking) formation and two players form a side by side, defensive formation. One player works hard in the rearcourt, playing dropshots between to 2 other players in a side by side formation. The two players continually lift to move the rearcourt player across the back line. The front player moves forwards to cover the net each time a dropshot is played (see first photo above) and moves slightly back when the shuttle is lifted.

• Work in doubles formations, one pair front and back (attacking) and the other side by side (defending). The defending pair moves the rearcourt player around. This player responds with dropshots between the two defending players. One defending player then lifts deliberately shorter and wide, giving the opportunity for the rearcourt player to:

- smash
- follow in to the net

The forecourt player moves across to allow the rearcourt player to follow up their smash. Players then play the rally out.

WHAT TO COACH: Women’s doubles defence (1)



When defending in women's doubles, players create a side by side formation.



For wider lifts the pair move across together towards the same side as the shuttle has been lifted. This allows them to deal more effectively with straight or down the middle replies from the attacker, which are the most frequent returns

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If one attacker is under some pressure in a rearcourt corner, both players can move further forwards. The cross-court player can take up a more advanced position:
• because cross-court strokes will take longer to reach them, so they will have more time to react
• to anticipate a dropshot to the centre



HOW TO COACH: Women's doubles defence
HOW TO COACH EXAMPLES

• Players are given a number or letter (1 and 2 on one side of the net, A and B on the other side of the net). These players all begin in side by side positions.No shuttles are involved in this practice. The coach calls out a number, then a letter, then a number, then a letter (e.g. 1, A, 1, B, 2, B etc.). When the number or letter is called out, that player moves to one side in the rearcourt and their partner takes up a front "channel attack" position. The opposing pair should automatically form a side by side position.

• The coach can encourage the side by side players to:
  - move slightly across to the same side as that of the opposition rearcourt player (see 2nd photo above);
  - stay slightly further forwards if they are the cross-court player.

• One player works hard in the rearcourt, playing dropshots between to players in a side by side formation. The two players lift to move the rearcourt player
across the back line. The side-by-side pair adjusts their positions by:
  - moving across as a pair towards the same side as the shuttle is lifted;
  - if they are the cross-court player, taking up a more advanced position depending up the degree of pressure on the rearcourt player.

WHAT TO COACH: Women's doubles defence (2)

The defenders should use blocks and drives into space in order to turn defence into attack. The blocking or driving player should aim wherever possible to move forwards to cover the net and force a lift off their counter-attacking stroke.



On some occasions, especially if the block is crosscourt, it may be better for the blocking player's partner to move forwards.



When lifting, either from the net or mid-court, consider:
• hitting cross-court lifts off straight attacking shots;
• straight lifts off cross-court attacking shots.
This tends to move the attacking team around more and can make it more difficult to sustain the attack.



HOW TO COACH: Women's doubles defence (2)
HOW TO COACH EXAMPLES

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• Play a game of doubles but no-one is allowed to lift off smashes. Players have to be creative to turn defence into attack;
• Play games where players:
  - can only lift cross-court off straight attacking shots;
  - can only lift straight off cross-court attacking shots.

The coach should the lead a discussion on the strengths and weaknesses of such an approach.

WHAT TO COACH: Low Serving in Men's Doubles (1)

In men's doubles, the server delivers from close to the "T" on the court, with their partner positioned centrally in the mid-court.



Low serves are generally delivered to the centre to cut down the possible angles of return.



• For variation, low serves can also be directed towards the receiver. This can disrupt their preferred way of returning serve.
• Occasionally you may serve wide into the tramlines, but this is a higher risk strategy as it makes the serving pair open to a straight return into space.



HOW TO COACH: Low Serving in Men's doubles (1)
HOW TO COACH EXAMPLES

Play a men's doubles games where only low serves are allowed.

Service receivers should:
• receive from their normal position;
• obey the rules by not moving before the serve is struck;
• be sensible about returns (e.g. not hitting hard at the head of the server);
• adjust their receiving position (i.e. slightly wider, slightly more central);
• carry their racket in different positions (wider on forehand, in front of body, wider on backhand).

Servers should vary where they serve to in response to the different positions and racket carriage of the receiver.

WHAT TO COACH: Low Serving in Men's doubles (2)

Following the low serve, the server should look to cover any net replies.



The server should also look to anticipate pushed replies to the mid and rearcourt. This usually involves choosing one side to cover.



The server's partner is responsible for covering returns to mid and rearcourt.



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HOW TO COACH: Low Serving in Men's doubles (2)
HOW TO COACH EXAMPLES

• Play men's doubles games where only low serves are allowed.
• Service receivers should:
    - receive from their normal position;
    - obey the rules by not moving before the serve is struck;
    - be sensible about returns (e.g. not hitting hard at the head of the server).
• The game is scored as normal, apart from the serving team being able to score two points if they win a rally with the 3rd shot of the rally.

WHAT TO COACH: Receiving low serves in men's doubles (1)

If the receiver plays a net reply to the serve, they should seek to dominate the net and kill any further net shots from the server.



Straight returns of serve to the mid-court should be followed by an attempt to intercept any straight replies.



Similarly, on playing a straight return to the rearcourt, the receiver should look to intercept any straight replies.



HOW TO COACH: Receiving low serves in men's doubles (1)
HOW TO COACH EXAMPLES

• Play men's doubles games where only low serves are allowed.
• Service receivers should:
    - receive from their normal position;
    - obey the rules by not moving before the serve is struck;
    - be sensible about returns (e.g. not hitting hard at the head of the server).

• The game is scored as normal, apart from the receiving team being able to score two points if they win a rally with the 4th shot of the rally.

WHAT TO COACH: Receiving low serves in men's doubles (2)

The receiver may choose to attack into the body of the server's partner, in which case they should prepare to cover both sides for a possible reply.



If the receiver plays an inaccurate return, they may have to retreat off the net and form a side by side formation.



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HOW TO COACH: Receiving low serves in men's doubles (2)
HOW TO COACH EXAMPLES

• Play men's doubles games where only low serves are allowed.
• Service receivers should:
○ receive from their normal position;
○ obey the rules by not moving before the serve is struck;
○ be sensible about returns (e.g. not hitting hard at the head of the server)
.
The game is scored as normal, apart from the receiving team being able to score two points if they win a rally with the 4th shot of the rally.
• Play men's doubles but no rally is allowed to go on longer than five shots. After five shots the rally is stopped and the point awarded to the doubles team on the attack/in control of the rally. Some lets may occur.

WHAT TO COACH Men's doubles flick serve

Flick serves can be used as a useful variation, pushing the receiver back and often forcing them to hit the shuttle when off-balance. Wide serves are often more difficult to deal with, especially out to the forehand side.



Wide flick serves often draw a predictable straight reply, which can be anticipated by the server's partner.



HOW TO COACH Men's doubles flick serve
HOW TO COACH EXAMPLES

Play a game with a higher than normal percentage of flick serves. Bonus points awarded to the serving team when they win rallies with a flick serve.

WHAT TO COACH Men's doubles flick serve return



If flicked wide and on-balance, smash at the straight player or between the two players. A dropshot placed between the two players is also a useful variation.



If flicked to the centre and on-balance, smash at the retreating server or between the two players. A dropshot placed between the two players is once again an option.

When returning a flick that has put the receiver offbalance consider using a half smash or dropshot, both of which give more time for the receiver to regain their balance.



HOW TO COACH: Men's doubles flick serve return
HOW TO COACH EXAMPLES

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Play a game with a higher than normal percentage of flick serves. Bonus points are awarded to the either team if they win a rally that began with a flick serve.

WHAT TO COACH Men's doubles rallying – rearcourt attack



When attacking at men's doubles the main responsibility of the rear player is to:

- cover the mid- and rearcourt;
- be patient, waiting for good attacking opportunities;
- set up attacking opportunities for the front player;
- hit winners.

The rear player uses:



- steep dropshots to pressurise their opponents;
- shots to the middle of the two players to cut down the angles of return (shown above);
- smashes, most often at the straight player or to the middle of the two players, to force a weak return or hit a winner;
- cross-court drops and smashes as a variation.

Players will rotate positions if:



- there is a good opportunity to follow their own attack positively and
- the front player has read the situation and commits more centrally to cover other areas of the court.

HOW TO COACH Men's doubles rallying – rearcourt attack
HOW TO COACH EXAMPLES

- One player works hard in the rearcourt, playing dropshots between two players in a side by side formation. The two players lift to move the rearcourt player across the back line.

- Work in doubles formations, one pair front and back (attacking) and the other side by side (defending). The defending pair moves the rearcourt player around. This player responds with dropshots between the two defending players. One defending player then lifts deliberately shorter and wide, giving the opportunity for the rearcourt player to:

    - smash;
    - follow in to the net.

The forecourt player moves across to allow the rearcourt player to follow up their smash. Players then play the rally out.

- Bonus points for rearcourt strokes that are winners, force an error or create a winner for the front player on the next shot.
- Place two markers on the net so the net is split into thirds. Place a further one marker in the centre of the net. (-------●--------●--------●---------). Play a normal game of doubles but dropshots from the left rearcourt must go through the ●---------● "gate", dropshots from right should go through the ●---------● "gate".

WHAT TO COACH Mens's doubles - front player attack (1)



When attacking at men's doubles the main responsibility of the front player is to:

- cover the mid- and forecourt;
- take the shuttle early;
- intercept drives and pushes;
- hit winners;

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• maintain the attack.

When lifted to the rearcourt, the front player should take up a midcourt position on the same side of the court as the shuttle. This "channel attack" position is most effective when the attack is directed at the straight player or to the middle, as it can create a 2 vs 1 situation.



HOW TO COACH: Mens's doubles - front player attack (1)
HOW TO COACH EXAMPLES

• Players are given a number or letter (1 and 2 on one side of the net, A and B on the other side of the net). These players all begin in side by side positions. No shuttles are involved in this practice. The coach calls out a number, then a letter, then a number, then a letter (e.g. 1, A, 1, B, 2, B etc.). When the number or letter is called out, that player moves to one side in the rearcourt and their partner takes up a front "channel attack" position. The opposing pair should automatically form a side by side position.

• Four players on the court, two on each side in side by side positions. One player "serves" a shuttle high (i.e. a straight lift) one side and the receiving pair move automatically in to a "channel attack" position. The rally is then played to a conclusion.
• Players can be encouraged to design short openings to rallies that help players form "side by side" and "channel attack" positions, then the players play the rally out.

WHAT TO COACH: Mens's doubles - front player attack (2)

When their partner is using dropshots, the front player should move in to the net to threaten and prevent any attempted net replies. The front player will know a dropshot has been played by the movement of the opposition



When the rear player has an opportunity to follow their own attack into the midcourt and forecourt, the front player can show they are ready for this by moving more to the centre line of the court, or even into the other half court. This allows them to cover the area of the court left by the advancing rearcourt player



HOW TO COACH: Mens's doubles - front player attack (2)
HOW TO COACH EXAMPLES

• Two players form a front and back (attacking) formation and two players form a side by side, defensive formation. One player works hard in the rearcourt, playing dropshots between to two other players in a side by side formation. The two players continually lift to move the rearcourt player across the back line. The front player moves forwards to cover the net each time a dropshot is played (see first photo above) and moves slightly back when the shuttle is lifted.

• Work in doubles formations, one pair front and back (attacking) and the other side by side (defending). The defending pair moves the rearcourt player around. This player responds with dropshots between the two defending players. One defending player then lifts deliberately shorter and wide, giving the opportunity for the rearcourt player to:

- smash
- follow in to the net

The forecourt player moves across to allow the rearcourt player to follow up their smash. Players then play the rally out.

WHAT TO COACH Men's doubles defence (1)

When defending in men's doubles, players create a side by side formation.



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For wider lifts the pair move across together towards the same side as the shuttle has been lifted. This allows them to deal more effectively with straight or down the middle replies from the attacker, which are the most frequent returns.



If one attacker is under some pressure in a rearcourt corner, both players can move further forwards. The cross-court player can take up more advanced position:

- because cross-court strokes will take longer to reach them, so they will have more time to react;
- to anticipate a dropshot to the centre.

HOW TO COACH Men's doubles defence (1)
HOW TO COACH EXAMPLES

• Players are given a number or letter (1 and 2 on one side of the net, A and B on the other side of the net). These players all begin in side by side positions. No shuttle s involved in this practice. The coach calls out a number, then a letter, then a number, then a letter (e.g. 1, A, 1, B, 2, B etc.). When the number or letter is called out, that player moves to one side in the rearcourt and their partner takes up a front "channel attack" position. The opposing pair should automatically form a side by side position.

• The coach can encourage the side by side players to:
  - move slightly across to the same side as that of the opposition rearcourt player (see 2nd photo above);
  - stay slightly further forwards if they are the cross-court player.

• One player works hard in the rearcourt, playing dropshots between to players in a side by side formation. The two players lift to move the rearcourt player across the back line.
• The side-by-side pair adjusts their positions by:

  - moving across as a pair towards the same side as the shuttle is lifted;
  - if they are the cross-court player, taking up a more advanced position depending up the degree of pressure on the rearcourt player.

WHAT TO COACH Men's doubles defence (2)

The defenders should use blocks and drives into space in order to turn defence into attack.



The blocking or driving player should aim wherever possible to move forwards to cover the net and force a lift off their counter-attacking stroke.

On some occasions, especially if the block is crosscourt, it may be better for the blocking player's partner to move forwards.



When lifting, either from the net or mid-court, consider:

- hitting cross-court lifts off straight attacking shots;
- straight lifts off cross-court attacking shots.



This tends to move the attacking team around more

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and can make it more difficult to sustain the attack.

HOW TO COACH Men's doubles defence (2)
HOW TO COACH EXAMPLES

• Play a game of doubles but no-one is allowed to lift off smashes. Players have to be creative to turn defence into attack.
• Play games where players:
  - can only lift cross-court off straight attacking shots;
  - can only lift straight off cross-court attacking shots.

The coach should the lead a discussion on the strengths and weaknesses of such an approach

MIXED DOUBLES TACTICS

INTRODUCTION

Mixed has many of the tactical characteristics of level doubles. The major difference is that the female player has less power than the male player. For this reason players aim to create situations where the female player can dominate the forecourt and mid-court, whereas the male player aims to dominate the midland rearcourt.

WHAT TO COACH: Man low serving in mixed doubles (1)

When the man serves from the right court, the women takes up a net position slightly to the left in the forecourt

.



When the man serves from the left court, the women can also take up a position slightly to left in the forecourt.



When the man serves from the left court, the women can also take up a position slightly to the right. This can disrupt the receiver's replies, particularly if they return a lot straight.



Low serves are generally delivered to the centre to restrict possible angles of return, or towards the receiver for variation. Following the serve, the man covers replies to the mid-court and rearcourt.



HOW TO COACH: Man low serving in mixeddoubles (1)
HOW TO COACH EXAMPLES

Play a mixed game and experiment with the woman's starting position when the man is serving from the left. Sometimes start with the woman on the left, sometimes start on the right.

WHAT TO COACH Woman low serving in mixed doubles (2)

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When the woman serves , their partner takes up a central position on the court



Low serves are generally delivered to the centre to restrict possible angles of return, or towards the receiver for variation. Wide serves can be used occasionally as a variation
Following the serve, the woman covers replies to the forecourt and mid-court



HOW TO COACH:Woman low serving in mixed doubles (2)
HOW TO COACH EXAMPLES

- Play a mixed doubles game where only low serves from the women players are allowed.
- Service receivers should:
    - receive from their normal position;
    - obey the rules by not moving before the serve is struck;
    - be sensible about returns (e.g. not hitting hard at the head of the server);
    - adjust their receiving position (i.e. slightly wider, slightly more central);
    - carry their racket in different positions (wider on forehand, in front of body, wider on backhand).
- Servers should vary where they serve to in response to the different positions and racket carriage of the receiver.

WHAT TO COACH: Mixed doubles –woman returning low serve (1)

If the female player is returning at mixed, then her partner takes up a central position in the court.



When returning serve to the net the woman should look to move in and dominate the forecourt.



HOW TO COACH: Mixed doubles –woman returning low serve (1)
HOW TO COACH EXAMPLES

Play a game where only the women players are receiving serve. Also consider placing an emphasis on particular type of return (straight, cross-court, rearcourt etc.). Encourage discussion with partners about the effectiveness of particular replies and each player's responsibilities after each reply.

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WHAT TO COACH Mixed doubles –woman returning serve (2)

If returning straight to the mid- or rearcourt, the woman should anticipate the straight replies.



The women can push returns into the body of the server's partner. Depending on the quality of her return she should attempt to cover both replies to the net and midcourt pushes.



HOW TO COACH Mixed doubles –woman returning serve (2)
HOW TO COACH EXAMPLES

Play a game where only the women players are receiving serve. Also consider placing an emphasis on particular type of return (straight, cross-court, rearcourt etc.). Encourage discussion with partners about the effectiveness of particular replies and each player's responsibilities after each reply.

WHAT TO COACH: Mixed doubles -man returning low serve

When the male is returning serve at mixed, their female partner usually stands alongside them.



The male player will play many returnsto the midcourt or rearcourt as this allows time for him to move back to cover his own mid- and rearcourt. Straight returns may also allow him to cover the third shot of the rally more often. Returns to the net, cross-court and at the body of the opposition can be used as variations.



The male looks to play returns which allow the female player to move forwards, however the female player should be aware that they may have to assist in the rearcourt.



If the return of serve has created a lot of pressure, the male player should stay in to try and finish the rally or create a good winning opportunity for their partner.



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HOW TO COACH:Mixed doubles -man returning serve
HOW TO COACH EXAMPLES

Play a game where only the men players are receiving serve. Also consider placing an emphasis on particular type of return (straight, cross-court, rearcourt etc.).Encourage discussion with partners about the effectiveness of particular replies and each player's responsibilities after each reply.

WHAT TO COACH; Flick serves in mixed doubles

Wide flick serves can be used in mixed, mainly against the woman to force her into the rearcourt. If the woman serves the flick, she should retreat slightly from the net. How far she retreats depends on the serve's effectiveness - the more off-balance the receiver and the later they take the shuttle the more the server can stay closer to the net.



Flick serves to the centre can also be used as a variation.



If the man flicks, then their partner wherever possible should move to a cross-court position. This allows that player more time to deal with the crosscourt replies and more opportunity to stay closer to the net.



HOW TO COACH: Flick serves in mixed doubles
HOW TO COACH EXAMPLES

Play a game with a higher than normal percentage of flick serves. Bonus points are awarded to the either team if they win a rally that began with a flick serve.



WHAT TO COACH; Mixed doubles –returning flick serve

If flicked wide attack the straight player's body or aim between the two players.Taking some pace off the stroke allows more recovery time. Alternatively, clear to the woman if possible.



If flicked wide down the centre, attack to the centre or at the body of the woman.Once again, taking some pace off the stroke allows more recovery time.Alternatively, clear cross-court to allow more time to recover into court

HOW TO COACH;Mixed doubles –returning flick serves
HOW TO COACH EXAMPLES

Play a game where there is a high proportion of flick serves, especially to the woman player. Experiment with a variety of returns. Discussion with partner and coach the effectiveness of different replies and the responsibilities of each player after the reply has been made (e.g. which court areas they would need to cover).



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WHAT TO COACH:Mixed doubles rallying – attack (1)

When attacking the preferred formation in mixed is front and back, with the man covering the mid- and rearcourt, where their additional power is useful.

Women should look to move forwards and dominate the mid- to forecourt.



During rallies, be patient and play with accuracy and steep angles - wait for a good opportunity to attack where more pace and power can be injected.



HOW TO COACH:Mixed doubles rallying – attack (1)
HOW TO COACH EXAMPLES

One pair starts side by side; one pair starts front and back. The shuttle is delivered high and deep to one corner. Players then play the rally out. Encourage discussion between pairs and use questioning to highlight aspects of good attacking practice (e.g. formation, patience, injection of pace etc.).

WHAT TO COACH:Mixed doubles rallying – attack (2)



Play a higher percentage of attacking strokes that are directed:

- at the straight player who has less time to react;
- between the two player to cut down the angles of return (see above).

Cross-court strokes should be used for variation.



Attacking clears can be useful to force the woman into the rearcourt where their reduced power may be exploited.

Make sure however that "playing on the woman" is not overdone and gives the attack away, particularly if the strokes are drawing the women into forecourt situations she can dominate.



HOW TO COACH:Mixed doubles rallying – attack (2)
HOW TO COACH EXAMPLES

One pair starts side by side; one pair starts front and back. The shuttle is delivered high and deep to one corner. Players then play the rally out. Encourage discussion between pairs and use questioning to highlight aspects of good attacking practice (e.g. formation, patience, injection of pace etc.).

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WHAT TO COACH:Mixed doubles defence (1)

The preferred formation for mixed defending is side by side, with the woman cross-court to the shuttle.



If forced to lift, then women generally should lift cross-court. This makes it less likely for the next attack to be directed at them. Women should only lift straight as an alternative provided that lift relieves rather than creates pressure.



A really wide and deep lift may also allow the woman to take a more advanced position towards the net.



HOW TO COACH:Mixed doubles defence (1)
HOW TO COACH EXAMPLES

Play a mixed game where the woman is only allowed to lift cross-court when returning dropshots and smashes. Then play a second game where both directions of lift are allowed. Partners then discuss the merits of the women lifting just cross-court, highlighting examples where this might not be the preferred option.

WHAT TO COACH:Mixed doubles defence (2)

Men usually lift straight, allowing them to take any resulting straight attack. Men should only lift cross-court as an alternative provided that lift relieves rather than creates pressure.



Pushes and blocks should be used extensively off smashes t o turn defence into attack, especially into the mid-court areas just behind the opposition front player.



HOW TO COACH: Mixed doubles defence (2)
HOW TO COACH EXAMPLES

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• Play a mixed game where the man is only allowed to lift straight when returning dropshots and smashes (note they can still play blocks and pushes in any direction). Then play a second game where both directions of lift are allowed. Partners then discuss the merits of the men lifting just straight, highlighting examples where this might not be the preferred option.

• Play a game where lifting off smashes are not allowed.

MODULE 7
SPORTS NUTRITION

INTRODUCTION

Food provides elements for:

- **Body structures building & repair**
- **Energy production its functions**
- **Identify food sources for nutrient**
- **Understand the general recommendation**
- **Fluid and electrolyte balance regulation**

OBJECTIVES

- **At the end of this lesson, participants will be able to:**
- **Define sports nutrition**
- **Identify 6 important nutrients &**
- **& sports nutrition myths**

CONTENT OVERVIEW

1. **INTRODUCTION OF SPORTS NUTRITION**
   Nutrition:
   Series of processes starting from food intake to utilization include eating, digestion, absorption, transport, metabolism of food nutrients.

   Sports Nutrition:

   Applies nutrition practices for maximal sports performance

Importance of Nutrition

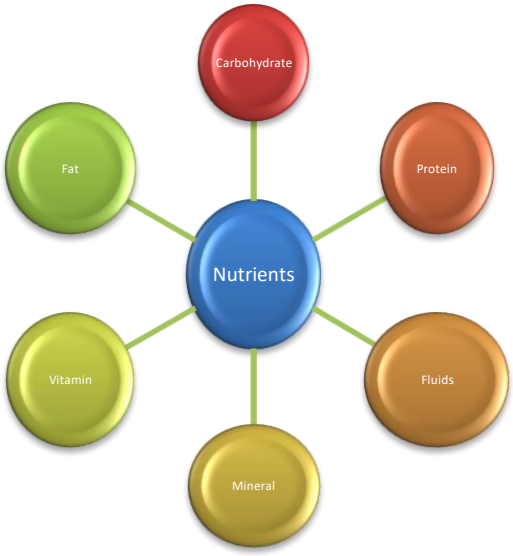
- **Basic nutrients requirement for health**
- **Provide required fuel for optimal performance**
- **Better & faster recovery**
- **Build and repair muscle damage due to exercise**
- **Prevent injury due to fatigue**
- **Reach and maintain optimal body weight and body fat level**

2. **TYPES OF NUTRIENT**
   Macronutrients:
   Daily requirement > 1 g / day (CHO, protein & fat)

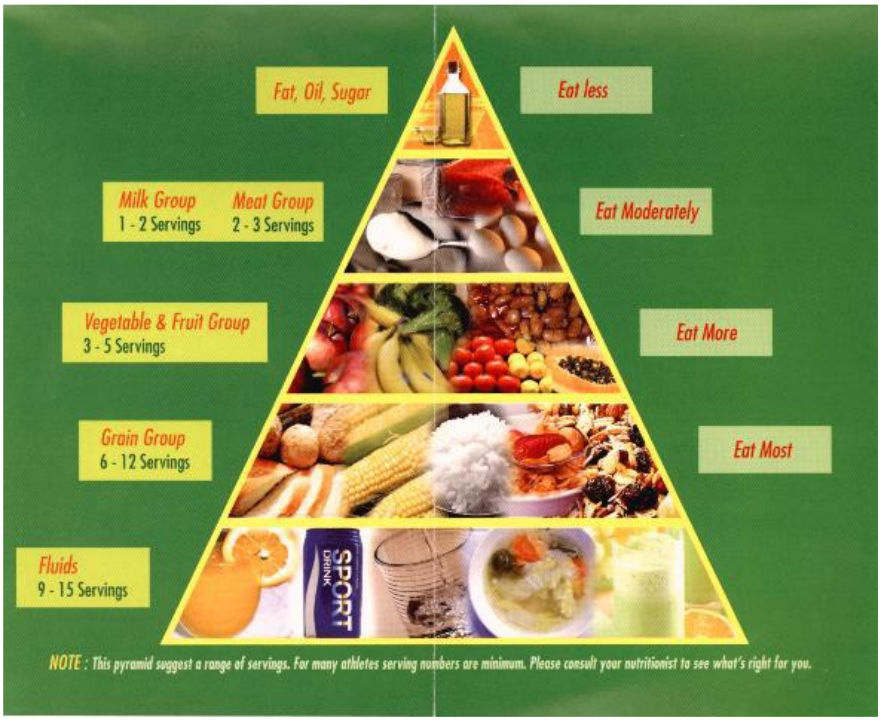
   Micronutrients:
   Daily requirement < 1 g / day (vitamin & mineral)

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Calorie providing nutrient: CHO, protein & fat. Non energy providing nutrient: vitamin, mineral & water.



Food pyramid guide



Keys for Healthy Diet

- **Balance: daily diet must consist all level from food pyramid**
- **Variety: not limited to 1 or 2 type of foods from each level**
- **Moderation: food intake according to requirement but not self-preference**

Balance **Variety** **Moderation**

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- **Food myths: the incorrect thinking or believe regarding food's function. Example:**

  i. **Turtle blood will be able to increase hemoglobin level**
  ii. **Horse's flesh could improve speed of running**
  iii. **Caffeine contain from Cola drinks can assist in sprinting event**
  iv. **High protein diet is a good choice to reduce body fat**
  v. **Eating more protein will improve someone's muscularity**
  vi. **Eating higher dose of vitamin & mineral will bring more benefit & better effect**

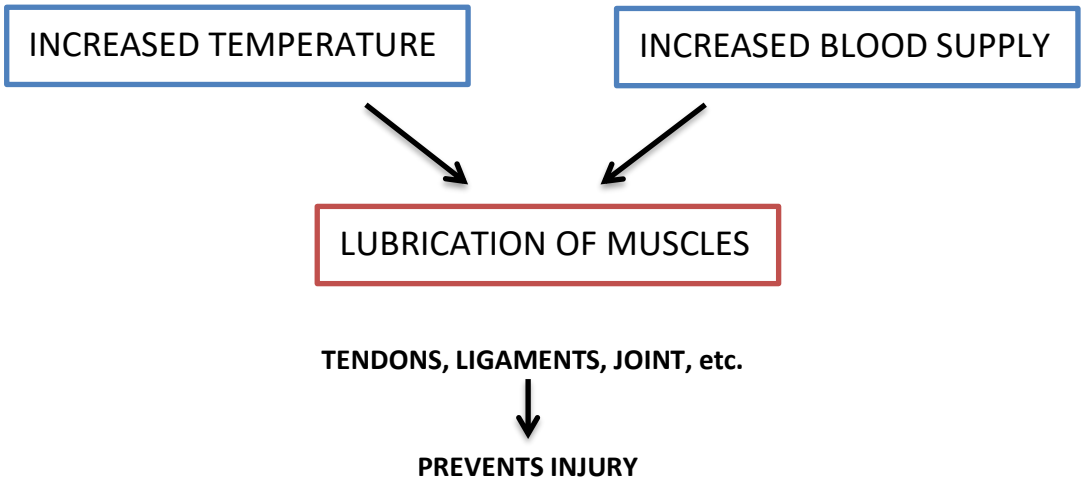
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MODULE 8
SPORTS SAFETY

PREVENTION OF INJURY

1. Warm up, stretching, cool down
2. Development of skills and techniques
3. Fitness
4. Obey the Rules
5. Playing areas and facilities
6. Protective devices
7. Environment factors
8. Manage existing injuries properly
9. Illness, medical condition and participation
10. Balanced competitions
11. Common sense

WHY WARM-UP?



WHY STRETCH?

- LENGTHEN MUSCLES & TENDONS
- ENHANCES PERFORMANCE
- INCREASE RELAXATION
- REDUCE MUSCLE TENSION
- PROMOTES BLOOD CIRCULATION
- PREVENTS INJURY

RULES FOR STRETCHING

1. WARM UPprior to stretching
2. STRETCHbefore and after exercise
3. STRETCH GENTLY and SLOWLY
4. NEVER BOUNCE orSTRETCH RAPIDLY
5. STRETCHto the point of tension or discomfort but NEVER PAIN

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6. **Do not hold your breath when stretching,breathing should be SLOWand EASY**
7. **HOLD for 10-20 seconds**
8. **The entire stretching session should take 15-20 minutes**

WARM UP

(e.g. For runners by Mac Brian)

- **5-10 minutes jogging**
- **10-15 minutes dynamic stretching exercises (reduce muscle stiffness)**
- **10-15 minutes general & specific drills**

e.g. lower leg drills

Technique

Neck Mobility

- **4-8 easy run out over 30-60 meters -focus on correct running technique**
- **Flexion / Extension -tuck chin into chest then lift chin upwards as far aspossible 6-10 reps**

Side Bends

- **16 reps**

Lunges

- **12-16 reps on each leg**

COOL DOWN?

- **REMOVE WASTE PRODUCTS**
- **RECOVER FASTER**
- **REDUCES BLOOD POOLING**
- **ABLE TO COMPETE AGAIN AT TOP LEVEL IN A SHORTER PERIODOF TIME**
- **REDUCE POST EXERCISE SORENESS**

DEHYDRATION

1. **Thirst is a poor indicator for fluid replacement.Thirst under estimates how much fluid youneed**
2. **PlainCOOL WATERis the best fluid replacement**

AVERAGE 15 YEAR OLD

- **45 minutes before300-400 ml (2 cups)**
- **During event150-200 ml (1 cups)**
- **After eventkeep drinking more than you think you need**

AVERAGE 10 YEAR OLD

- **45 minutes before150-200 ml (1 cups)**
- **During event75-100 ml (1/2 cups) every 15 minutes**
- **After eventkeep drinking more than you think you need**

RICER

R-Rest

- **HOW**
  Place the athlete i ɔn, preferably lying down. The injured part should be immobilized and s

- **WHY**
  Activity promotes bleeding byincreasing blood flow

I-Ice

- **HOW**

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Conventional Methods:

- ✓ **Crushed ice in a wet towel/plastic bag**
- ✓ **Immersion in ice water**
- ✓ **Commercial cold packs wrapped in wettowel**
- ✓ **Cold water from the tap is better than nothing**

Apply for 20 minutes every 2 hours for the first 48 hours

- ✓ **Do not apply ice directly to skin as ice burn can occur**
- ✓ **Do not apply ice to people who are sensitive to cold or have circulatory problems**
- ✓ **Children have a lower tolerance to ice**

- **WHY**

Ice reduces:

- ✓ **Swelling**
- ✓ **Pain**
- ✓ **Muscle Spasm**
- ✓ **Secondary damage to theinjured area**

C-Compression

- **HOW**

Apply a firm wide elastic bandage over a large area covering the injured parts, as well as, above and below the injured part

- **WHY**

Compression:

- ✓ **Reduces bleeding and swelling**
- ✓ **Provides support for the injured part**

E-Elevation

- **HOW**

Raise injured area above the level of the heart at all possible times

- **WHY**

Elevation:

- ✓ **Reduces bleeding and swelling**
- ✓ **Reduces pain**

R-Referral

- **HOW**

Refer to a suitable qualified professional such as a Doctor or Physiotherapist for a definitive diagnosis and ongoing care

- **WHY**

Early referral for definitive diagnosis to ascertain the exact nature of the injury and to gain expert advice on the rehabilitation program required

ICE SENSATIONS

- **STAGE -1 COLD**
- **STAGE – 2 WARMING SENSATION(SHORT TIME)**
- **STAGE – 3 ACHING IN INJURED AREA(30 Sec -1 Minutes)**
  MAYBE SEVERE PAIN (DEPENDING ON INDIVIDUAL)
- **STAGE – 4 NUMBNESS**

NO HARM - FOR FIRST 2 - 3 DAYS

- **HEAT increase bleeding**
- **ALCOHOL increase swelling**
- **RUNNING or exercising too soon can make the injury worse**

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- **MASSAGE in the first 48-72 hours increases swelling and bleeding**

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